

First Time as a School Parent —————

Leap Forward, School Parent

————— High School



교육부



국가평생교육진흥원

Introduction

For a student to grow up healthy, the role of parents as the primary caregivers and educators is crucial. Parents guide their children in all areas, from basic life habits to social skills, adapting to school, and even exploring future careers.

However, the role of parents often depends on their own experiences and abilities, and many feel burdened by the expectation that they must acquire all the necessary knowledge and skills for raising their children on their own. In addition, the growing social emphasis on parents as key educational agents in today's rapidly changing digital age places even greater pressure on them.

In response, the Ministry of Education published in 2024 a report titled *The Direction and Challenges of Parent Policies for the Healthy Growth of All Students*. This report identified essential qualities for parents and provided examples of parent education tailored to each stage of a child's development, based on the findings of the *Development Research on Competency and Growth-Focused Parent Education Framework*. Furthermore, drawing on five competency clusters established through this research, the Ministry, in collaboration with the National Institute for Lifelong Education's National Center for All Parents and researchers at Seoul National University, developed the *School-Parent Guidebook* to help parents fulfill their roles appropriately at each stage of their child's growth, from birth to independent adulthood.

This guidebook, structured around seven developmental stages from infancy to early adulthood, provides parents with essential information to support their child's growth and to foster communication and cooperation with schools. While limitations in length mean that it cannot fully address the diversity of family types, individual student characteristics, or educational contexts, it is our hope that this guidebook will still serve as a helpful resource for parents as they reflect on how best to raise their children and consider their role throughout the different stages of development.

We look forward to building a healthy educational community in Korea, where we can “all learn, nurture, and grow together.”

High School

Introduction to the School-Parent Guidebook



1. Approach to Development

With Excitement, With Love

Do you remember the **first** time you held your child?

Every first encounter begins with excitement. Then, everyday life with your child becomes filled with patience and love. This special relationship continues as your child grows, and you, as a parent, also learn and mature.

When your child is young, the family serves as the primary nurturing environment. As they grow, teachers and schools become educational partners. Now, parents take on the role of school parents.

School parents enter the realm of school, hoping for their child's healthy growth. As they observe and engage with their child's school life and curriculum, they soon recognize the importance of developing themselves as active participants in education. In fulfilling this role, they also understand that being familiar with their rights and responsibilities—and exercising them—is essential for nurturing all children into responsible members of society. However, putting this knowledge into practice is not always easy.

This guidebook was created to help parents in Korea navigate the challenges and difficulties of raising children. It is meant for all family members who care for and nurture children, including parents as key stakeholders in school education.

We hope it will serve as a foundation for the growth of both children and parents, and as a helpful compass for parents in their daily parenting.

To support your journey as a **new** school parent, we developed the following directions for **parent** development based on studies of parental competency and education, together with surveys and focus group interviews with experts, parents, and teachers in Korea and abroad.

- This guidebook focuses on key areas to consider at each stage of your child's development, which we call "competencies." It covers core skills, the role of school curricula, ways to communicate between home and school, and strategies for working together in education.
- This guidebook is designed to support your child's healthy growth, help schools improve, and encourage reflection on the kind of parent needed to guide children into responsible members of society. Importantly, it emphasizes that you are not alone and that parenting is a shared journey.
- The guide is reflective and participatory, so you can think about your own parenting style and ask yourself questions. You can fill in the guidebook as your child grows to create your own personalized resource.
- We also provide information for parents supporting children who have left school or are learning outside of school.
- Any additional content that could not fit in print is available through QR codes, which link to online resources in the e-book version.
- You can download this guidebook from Parent Onnuri (www.parents.go.kr) under Resources – Guidebooks. We recommend reading both the guidebook for your child's current stage and the next stage, and using other educational materials on the website to enrich your parenting journey.

Travel guides may give accurate information, but the experiences you have when you travel yourself are always original. Likewise, each child is unique, and the world keeps changing. There is not a one-size-fits-all answer. We hope that, with love for your children each day, you will make thoughtful, wise, and individualized decisions. Through the many challenges and trial-and-error, parents will grow right alongside their children.

This guidebook is meant to help you with the new chapter of continuous change and growth. We will always cheer on you, parents, as you accompany your children on their journey of growth!

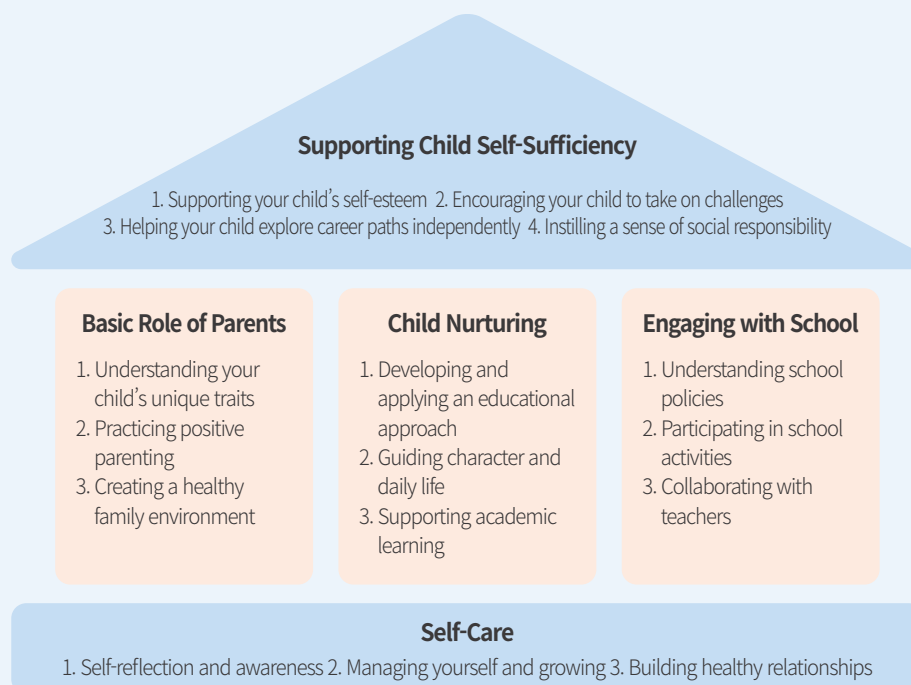
2. Content Framework

This guidebook focuses on the following five competencies of school parents. A total of seven books have been published, corresponding to each stage of child development—infancy, toddlerhood, lower elementary, upper elementary, middle school, high school, and early adulthood—each detailing the specific qualities relevant to that stage.

✿ Five Competencies of School Parents

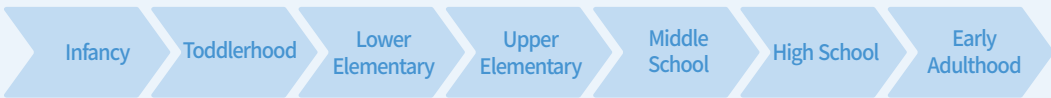
- 1) Self-Care: The competency to care for one's well-being in order to fulfill the role of a school parent effectively
- 2) Basic Role of Parents: The essential competency required to perform the responsibilities of a school parent successfully
- 3) Child Nurturing: The competency to provide education and character development with an appropriate educational mindset
- 4) Engaging with School: The competency to collaborate with schools to support a child's growth and development
- 5) Supporting Child Self-Sufficiency: The competency to foster a child's independence and help them become a healthy member of society

School Parent Competency System Model



※ Source: Ministry of Education. *Development Research on Competency and Growth-Focused Parent Education Framework*, 2024.

*** Seven Stages of Child Development**



3. School-Parent Guidebook: High School

The high school parent guidebook is designed to support the developmental growth of high school students by strengthening the following sets of parental competencies: self-care, fundamental parenting, child education, school partnership, and child independence support. The guidebook provides resources to help parents assist their children in exploring career paths, offer emotional support, create conducive learning environments, and prepare for independence. Its content is organized as follows:

Chapter 1. Self-Care: Meeting the Self Within

To communicate effectively with their children, parents first need to explore their own experiences as individuals before identifying themselves primarily as parents. This chapter promotes active self-understanding by identifying one’s personality type and its influence on parenting style, reflecting on personal growth experiences and available resources, and envisioning the future. It also covers practical approaches to self-care, including exploring interests, examining personal relationships, and managing stress.

Competencies	Key Skills	Focus Areas
Self-reflection and awareness	Self-reflection	1. What kind of person are Mom and Dad? 2. What makes me happy?
Self-management and growth	Self-confidence management; health management	
Building healthy relationships	Forming supportive relationships; fostering supportive parent relationships	

Chapter 2. Basic Role of Parents: Passing Happiness On as a Parent

High school is a critical stage for students to not only focus on academics but also to develop emotional stability and establish a positive direction for their lives. This chapter encourages parents to engage in meaningful conversations with their children about life values, career paths, and occupational goals through career-value exploration activities. It also introduces ways to cultivate unique family habits that foster emotional connection—using the concept of “love languages” to help family members express affection effectively toward one another.

Competencies	Key Skills	Focus Areas
Understanding your child's unique traits	Understanding your child's disposition and temperament	1. I'm curious about your values 2. How to connect with your child through conversation
Practicing positive parenting	Managing your child's mental health; empathic communication	
Creating a healthy family environment	Respecting and exercising your child's rights	

Chapter 3. Child Nurturing: Becoming an Expert in Child Nurturing

One of the greatest challenges in raising a high school student lies in balancing academic achievement and emotional health. This chapter helps parents identify their child's learning style and explore personalized learning strategies. It also presents practical support methods for developing grit—the passion and perseverance for long-term goals—and for managing test anxiety. Additionally, it examines cases of digital misuse and introduces AI-based learning platforms that can be effectively utilized to support students' learning in the digital era.

Competencies	Key Skills	Focus Areas
Guiding character and daily life	Life guidance and behavior management; safe digital use guidance	1. Balancing academics and emotional well-being 2. A changing world: life in the digital age
Supporting academic learning	Providing motivation for learning; supporting self-directed learning	

Chapter 4. Engaging with School: Partnering with School for Your Child's Future

Parent-teacher consultations can remain challenging no matter how often they occur. This chapter provides actionable guidance on how to communicate effectively with teachers, collaborate with schools, and participate in the shared work of shaping a student's career and future. It also introduces recent educational policies and useful information that parents can readily apply to support their child's development.

Competencies	Key Skills	Focus Areas
Understanding school policies	Understanding educational changes; understanding the curriculum	1. Cooperating with teachers 2. Digesting educational policies
Participating in school activities	Participating in school education; communicating and cooperating with school communities; utilizing local community resources	
Collaborating with teachers	Cooperative communication; trusting and respecting teachers; forming a parent-teacher partnership	

Chapter 5. Supporting Child Self-Sufficiency: Giving Wings of Independence

All parents share the same concern as their children stand on the threshold of adulthood. This chapter provides career aptitude assessments and academic/occupational information to assist students in making autonomous and forward-looking career decisions. It also introduces the psychosocial characteristics of adolescents that parents should be aware of when helping their children prepare for independence and self-reliance.

Competencies	Key Skills	Focus Areas
Supporting your child's self-esteem	Supporting self-esteem; supporting resilience	1. Emerging careers? 2. Fostering independence in your child
Encouraging your child to take on challenges	Providing opportunities for creative problem-solving	
Helping your child explore career paths independently	Providing opportunities for self-understanding; supporting career exploration	
Instilling a sense of social responsibility	Cultivating social responsibility; cultural sensitivity education	

→ Each chapter is organized as follows.

Each chapter may be structured differently depending on the topic.

[Me as a School Parent]

- This section helps parents reflect on the challenges, dilemmas, and insights they face in relation to the topic, using examples, information, checklists, and reflection questions.



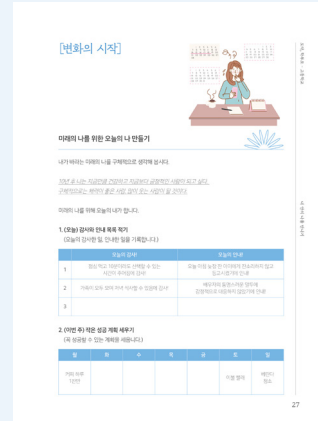
[Take a Step Forward Today]

- Each chapter is organized into three progressive stages: Step 1, Step 2, and Step 3, according to the specific subtopics. To enhance practical understanding of commonly asked questions, the guidebook includes Q&A sections, expert interviews, and TIPS drawn from real-life experiences. Additional materials, information, and theoretical resources can be accessed by scanning the provided QR codes.



[The Beginning of Change]

- This section provides concrete practices and activity sheets related to each topic, enabling parents to apply and reflect on the content in their daily lives. Using these materials, parents can implement effective parenting strategies in everyday situations.



[Leaving Footprints]

- This closing section is designed to assess parents' understanding of the chapter. Based on this reflection, parents can identify what is personally meaningful, what new insights they have gained, and what areas require further learning. Finally, it encourages parents to formulate actionable steps for their growth as caregivers.

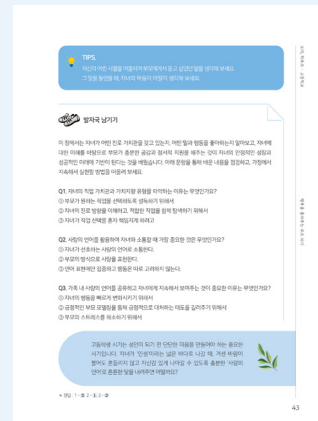


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Chapter 1

Meeting the Self Within



1. What Kind of Person Are Mom and Dad?

#Self-Reflection, #Fostering Supportive Parent Relationships

2. What Makes Me Happy?

#Self-Confidence Management, #Forming Supportive Relationships,
#Health Management

When you look at yourself in the mirror, you see not only a version of yourself that reflects a certain maturity, but also the people you cherish most—your family. A healthy and effective parent is one who cares for both themselves and their children. Will you embark on a journey that begins with “self” and leads to “your child”?

[Me as a School Parent]

When It Gets Hard

The most crucial stage in my child's life.

I wish to discuss my child's future, yet often find it difficult to do so.

I reflect on that period in my own life.

I also worry about how I'm perceived by my child today.



It's Okay, These Things Happen!

High school students experience significant physical and emotional growth while considering their future direction, marking a pivotal stage on the path to adulthood. Naturally, they encounter various challenges along the way. Parenting a high school student is itself a new challenge, and it is understandable that parents may feel uncertain or overwhelmed.

From the onset of adolescence, it is important to practice seeing your child as an independent individual. Although conversations with a now-grown high schooler may be abundant and meaningful, it can be helpful to first reflect on oneself. This guidebook seeks to connect the "self" you were at your child's age with the "self" you are today.



Let's Check In with Ourselves

Self-identity refers to the ability to answer the question “Who am I?” for oneself. It encompasses thoughts and feelings about oneself, as well as the ways in which one defines who they are. By responding to the questions below, you can reflect on and clarify your own self-perception.

1. A characteristic that represents me is affinity.
2. I tend to enjoy trying new experiences that I have not encountered before.
3. I possess stronger leadership or initiative skills compared to others.
4. I often _____ and regret it afterward.
5. When I am with people I am not close to, I tend to _____.
6. I tend to _____ to external changes.
7. I am _____ at making decisions independently.
8. If I had grown up in a different family environment, _____ would have been different.
9. When I want to do something, I tend to _____.
10. I tend to _____ regarding how I want to live my life.

While our role as parents is important, understanding our self-identity as individuals is equally valuable. Exploring and discovering your values and beliefs strengthens your sense of self. Respecting and nurturing yourself, while maintaining love and responsibility as a parent, is also a personal responsibility you hold toward yourself.

Let's Think

- What kind of person does my spouse or child think I am?
- What led to those thoughts?

1. What Kind of Person Are Mom and Dad?

#Self-Reflection

#Fostering Supportive Parent Relationships

[Take a Step Forward Today]

One day, a child who had just entered high school asked their mother, with curious eyes, “What was your dream when you were young?” Then the child asked, “What kind of student were you?” The mother answered with the expected reply: she was the quietest student in the class and always followed the teacher’s instructions. The child, however, insisted that couldn’t be true; they imagined their mother as loud, quick-tempered at times, and popular among friends. Upon reflection, it seemed that the mother’s childhood self and her current self as a parent were somewhat different. I find myself curious about me, too!

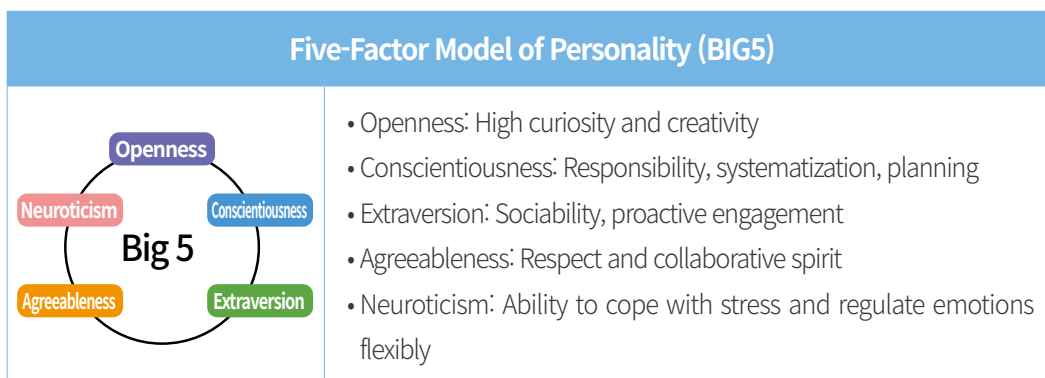
Exploring My Personality

Who Am I?



Who Am I?

While each person has a unique personality, we can often identify a few traits that most represent ourselves. The Five-Factor Model of Personality (BIG5) categorizes human personality into five dimensions, often summarized as OCEAN:



Considering your typical tendencies, let's predict your personality according to the Five-Factor Model (BIG5).

Trait	0 pts (Very Low)	↔	100 pts (Very High)	Highest Tendency	Lowest Tendency
Openness			pts		
Conscientiousness			pts		
Extraversion			pts		
Agreeableness			pts		
Neuroticism			pts		

You can take a free **BIG5 personality test** by searching online.

Which traits stand out most for you?

It is uncommon for someone to score very high or very low in all five areas. Everyone has areas of strength as well as traits that may be less developed. Your personality tendencies can influence your parenting style and approach. How might your own traits affect the way you raise your child?

1) Parents High in Openness Creative, curious, and eager for new ideas and experiences, you are likely to provide your child with diverse experiences, foster creativity and imagination, and model a positive, flexible attitude toward change.



TIPS. Being an Open Parent

- ☒ Suggest new experiences: "Let's visit a museum this weekend to see a new exhibition!"
- ☒ Show interest in your child's imaginative ideas: "That's a fascinating idea! How did you come up with it?"

2) Parents High in Conscientiousness Responsible, organized, and thorough in planning, you are likely to raise your child in a structured, goal-oriented way, modeling responsibility and planning skills effectively.



TIPS. Being a Conscientious Parent

- ☒ Emphasize time management rather than scolding for procrastination: "We'll eat dinner at 7 pm, and homework should be done by 8 pm."
- ☒ Monitor academic or extracurricular progress carefully: "How are you preparing for this science project?"

- 3) Parents High in Extraversion** Energetic and sociable, you enjoy interacting with others and create a lively home atmosphere. You convey positive energy and actively communicate with your child.



TIPS. Being an Extraverted Parent

- ☒ Actively participate in school events, open classes, and curriculum briefings, engaging with other parents.
- ☒ Designate a day to do whatever your child wants—dining out, shopping, or watching movies—to relieve stress and enjoy quality time together.

- 4) Parents High in Agreeableness** Kind, considerate, and empathetic, you foster trust and stability, creating a warm environment where your child feels comfortable sharing their emotions and concerns.



TIPS. Becoming an Agreeable Parent

- ☒ When your child is upset about exams or peer relationships, ask: “Can you tell me what happened?” to offer empathy and support.
- ☒ In case of parent-child conflicts, say: “Let’s try to understand each other. How can we feel better?” to help manage emotions and encourage problem-solving.

- 5) Parents Low in Neuroticism** Calm and stable, you focus on problem-solving. When your child feels anxious or worried, you provide reassurance and help them develop resilience and balanced growth.



TIPS Becoming a Low-Neurotic Parent

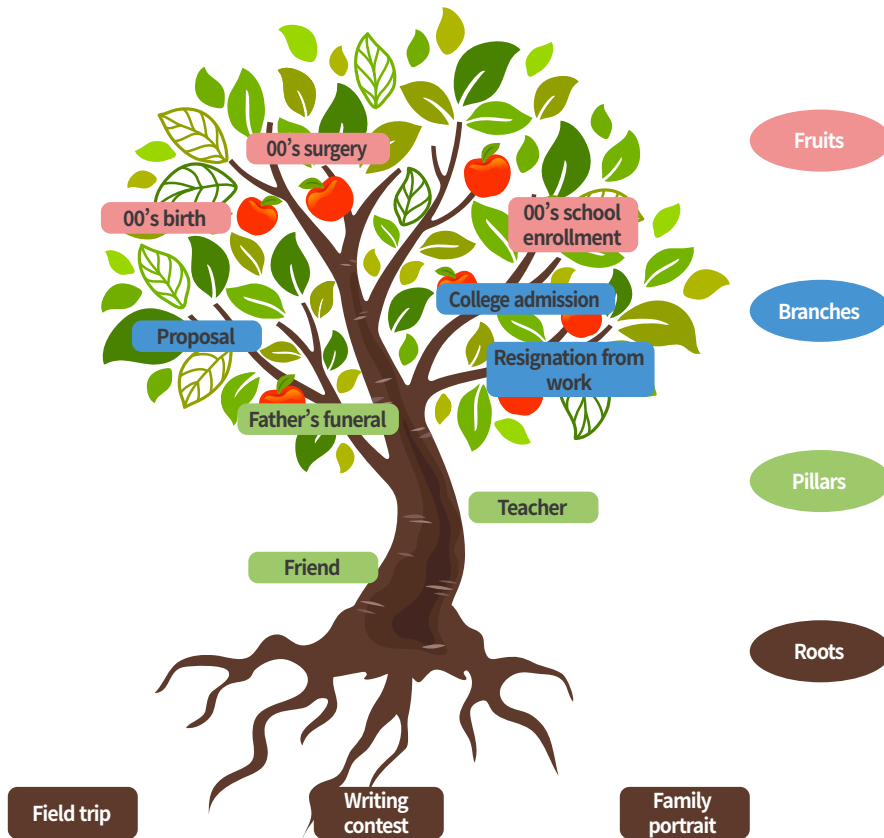
- ☒ Before an important presentation, reassure your child: “It’s normal to feel nervous, but you’ve prepared well. Just follow your plan, and it’s okay to make mistakes.”
- ☒ When plans are canceled, suggest alternatives: “It’s disappointing it didn’t work out, but let’s find something fun to do now. Next time, we’ll make sure to go.”

Parents who are boisterous in voice and hearty in laughter, and who easily form relationships, are high in extraversion and can become joyful, friend-like figures for their children. Understanding your own personality type allows you to better recognize how you respond and communicate, enabling you to select appropriate approaches in interactions with your child. Moreover, identifying areas of weakness provides opportunities to develop strategies to compensate for them, promoting more balanced parenting. When you understand yourself, your child understands you, too—try putting this into practice.



My Experiences Growing Up

How Have I Lived My Life?



<Example of My Personal Growth Tree>

Reflecting on Life Experiences

The person you are today has been shaped by the accumulation of various experiences and thoughts since early childhood. Reflect on events that influenced your growth during infancy, childhood, adolescence, and adulthood, including your experiences as a parent. Of course, not all experiences were positive. You may record negative or difficult events privately. If a single word cannot capture the experience, feel free to write in detail.

- **Fruits** Parenting Stage: Events that occurred after becoming a parent
- **Branches** Young Adulthood: Key life events such as career development or marriage
- **Pillars** Adolescence: School adaptation, peer relationships, conflicts with parents, academic stress
- **Roots** Infancy and Early Childhood: Events related to attachment with parents or caregivers

Assigning Meaning to Experiences

Summarize each event recorded in your Growth Tree with a single keyword. In the adjacent column, note related people, emotions, or any words that come to mind. This process allows you to observe how you processed and internalized each experience.

<Example Analysis of My Personal Growth Tree>

Stages	Subjects	Relevant People, Places, Emotions, Words
Roots (Infancy & Early Childhood)	Picnic	Packed rice balls for a picnic, parents, warmth, nostalgia
	Writing contest	The day I discovered my dream, teacher's praise, regret
	Family portrait	First family photo taken, new clothes, alley in 00 neighborhood
Pillars (Adolescence)	Teacher	Literature teacher, encouragement, literary journal, sense of emptiness
	Father's death	___ (Month) ___ (Day), longing, sadness, feeling left behind, ___ Hospital, a personal vow
	Friend	Difficulty adjusting after changing schools, anger, resentment, sadness, regret, overcame
Branches (Young Adulthood)	College admission	
	Proposal	
	Resignation from work	
Fruits (Parenting Stage)	Birth	
	Surgery	
	School enrollment	

Rising from Life Experiences

Having reviewed the many experiences you have gone through, you have noted the most significant events, the people involved, the emotions, and the words that come to mind. Some topics may still feel uncomfortable, while others may now feel easier to recall. Consider how these experiences may influence your parenting. Use the examples provided below each sentence to record your thoughts, actions, or responses.

- **I feel happiest when my child:** _____
☐ Treats me kindly ☐ Gets good grades ☐ Eats well ☐ Works hard
- **I feel most angry when my child:** _____
☐ Is not diligent ☐ Gets poor grades ☐ Does not behave with good character
☐ Does not think about the future ☐ Does not follow my instructions
- **When my child achieves something, I praise them by saying:** _____
☐ "Everyone can do that, right?" ☐ "You've done so well now—why didn't you do this before?"
☐ "I knew you could do it! Keep it up next time!" ☐ "All your hard work is paying off! Amazing!"
- **When my child makes a mistake, I say:** _____
☐ "Oh no, you shouldn't have been so careless!" ☐ "Next time, don't make the same mistake."
☐ "That must be frustrating. Let's have something nice to eat today and move on."
☐ "Think about why this mistake happened."
- **When my child's opinion differs from mine, I try to:** _____
☐ Persuade them ☐ Understand them ☐ Compromise ☐ Ignore them ☐ Scold them



A parent's own growth background significantly influences the formation of relationships with their child and forms the basis of the parent's educational values and belief system. By understanding this background, parents can provide more effective educational guidance and emotional support, and better comprehend their child's perspective. Moreover, drawing on their own experiences and lessons learned allows parents to offer improved advice and guidance, positively impacting their child's development.

My Support

What Supports Me?



Each individual has different interests, strengths, possessions, and aspirations. Therefore, it is important to appreciate what you have and plan your life around what you want to achieve. Before considering your role as a parent, take time to assess the resources you possess as a person.

Types of Resources

Let's take a look at the three types of resources below.

Human Resources	Human resources serve as a support network when needed and play a crucial role in parenting. Friends, family, and professionals provide access to information and assistance necessary for your child's growth.
Material Resources	Material resources include basic living expenses and the means to support your child's education and daily life more securely. By understanding and managing your family's finances, you can prepare efficiently for tuition, books, and other education-related expenses, allowing your child to focus on learning without financial concerns.
Internal Resources	Internal resources are linked to your personal strengths and potential, contributing to emotional stability. Clearly understanding your values and strengths, along with learning stress management skills, also positively affects your child. When parents maintain a stable and positive attitude, children grow in a healthier and more secure environment.

Exploring the Resources that I Have

Let us reflect on ourselves and our surroundings to explore the resources we possess. Review the resources listed below and mark with a ☒ those you believe you currently have. Additionally, if there are resources not listed that you possess or wish to acquire, please write them down.

My Resources					
Human Resources		Material Resources		Internal Resources	
☐	Parents & Spouse	☐	Real estate	☐	Perseverance and patience
☐	Siblings	☐	Financial assets (Deposits, stocks, etc.)	☐	Confidence
☐	Close friends & School friends	☐	Transportation (Car)	☐	Empathy for others
☐	Fellow parents	☐	Hobby and leisure equipment	☐	Self-motivation
☐	Colleagues	☐	Books	☐	Positive thinking
☐		☐		☐	
☐		☐		☐	

Does having many resources make a person wealthy, and having few resources make a person poor?

At first glance, one might think so based on what is tangible and visible. However, this is not necessarily the case. Material resources cannot always be obtained in proportion to one's effort, and having more does not automatically lead to greater happiness.

By contrast, the internal resources that drive you and the human resources—the people who support you in times of difficulty—may not be visible to others, but they are invaluable and cannot be exchanged for any material wealth. It is important to review your resources, be grateful for what you have, and focus on what you can build through effort.



Analyzing My Resources

Let's take a closer look at the resources you possess. If your most abundant resource is also the most important, or your most limited resource is the least important, there may be little to worry about. However, if this is not the case, it may be necessary to plan how to secure and strengthen your resources. Review the resources you marked earlier and respond to the following questions:

- Which of your resources is the most abundant? (**Confidence**)
How important is this most abundant resource? (**8/10**)
- Which of your resources is the most limited? (**Financial assets**)
How important is this most limited resource? (**10/10**)
- Which resource do you need to secure more of? (**Financial assets**)
Have you developed a sufficient plan to secure this additional resource? (**8/10**)
- What are your most important resources? (1st priority: ____, 2nd priority: ____, 3rd priority: ____)
- As a parent, which resources do you consider most important? ()
- Which resources do you most want to pass on to your child? ()



Resource management is a crucial tool for fostering a healthy family life and ensuring a satisfying quality of life. By analyzing relationships, time, energy, finances, emotions, and temperament in detail, parents can support both their child's development and their own well-being. Caring for yourself as a person and raising your child as a parent requires setting priorities among limited resources, allocating them wisely, and finding ways to connect and use them efficiently.

2. What Makes Me Happy?

#Self-Confidence Management

#Forming Supportive Relationships

#Health Management

[Take a Step Forward Today]

As my child gradually becomes independent and begins to lead their own life, I too may focus on a life dedicated to myself. While I may miss the youthful version of myself before parenthood, the growth I have experienced while raising my child allows me to appreciate my current self. Rather than attempting to return to the past, I want to take time to reflect deeply on my present self and discover new aspects of who I am.

Curiosity About Myself

What Do I Enjoy?



Exploring Myself

Being curious about oneself is a process of investigating what you like, what you do well, and which values you hold important. This self-exploration contributes to personal development and growth. By exploring your own interests and hobbies, parents can reduce stress and prevent becoming solely focused on caregiving responsibilities. Additionally, engaging in new activities allows parents to share diverse experiences with their children, enriching conversation topics and deepening relationships. Let's cultivate curiosity and explore our interests.

1. Reflecting on Past Experiences	• Ask Questions What activities did I enjoy as a child? When was I so absorbed in something that I lost track of time? Which moments in my life gave me the greatest sense of accomplishment? • Record Recall past experiences and write down what I enjoyed. Note any activities I still find interesting or meaningful today.
2. Starting Something New	• Start Small Try new activities even in small ways: cooking, drawing, playing an instrument, sports, reading, writing, etc. Explore local workshops, lectures, hobby clubs, or community programs. • Don't Fear Failure I may not enjoy every new experience, but even discovering that is part of the journey of self-discovery.

3. Using a Self-Reflection Journal	• Short Writing Exercises What topics make me most curious and engaged when discussing them? What subjects have I recently researched or looked up? Which activities do I willingly dedicate time to? Are there things I want to do regardless of money, success, or recognition?
4. Observing Daily Patterns	• Keep a Daily Record Track how I spend my time each day and identify moments I enjoyed. • Track Emotions Notice which activities reduce stress and which ones energize me.

Building Relationships for Yourself

Interacting with other parents can provide valuable support, offering new information about your child's school life and future opportunities, as well as a space to share similar concerns. Most importantly, building positive connections with others provides emotional support and psychological stability for parents themselves, enhancing overall life satisfaction.

Reflecting on the resources you explored earlier, consider what new relationships you may need and how you can establish them.

- **Close Friends, Schoolmates:** Relationships that offer emotional support by spending time together and sharing difficulties



TIPS. Building New Connections

Keep in regular contact with existing friends and spend quality time together.

- **Fellow Parents:** Parents of children of similar age, sharing experiences and information



TIPS. Building New Connections

Participate in school parent meetings or community activities. Communicate with the parents of your child's friends and build relationships.

- **Club/Hobby Group Members:** Connections formed around shared interests or activities



TIPS. Building New Connections

Join groups or clubs related to sports, reading, art, travel, or other hobbies you enjoy.

- **Online Friends:** Connections through online cafés, social media groups, or interest-based communities that provide support and connection beyond physical distance



TIPS. Building New Connections

Join online groups that share your interests or goals.

- **Neighbors:** Relationships formed through local organizations, religious groups, or volunteer activities that foster a sense of belonging



TIPS. Building New Connections

Participate in volunteer work, local events, or neighborhood meetings to expand your network.

- **Colleagues:** Connections that provide practical advice and support by sharing common experiences and challenges



TIPS. Building New Connections

Engage in informal conversations with colleagues and actively collaborate on projects or team activities.

- **Mentors & Advisors:** Relationships that share experience and guidance to support personal or professional growth



TIPS. Building New Connections

Reach out to respected seniors or professionals in your field and ask for a conversation.

Parents of high school students tend to focus primarily on their children. Taking an interest in areas outside of their children's lives may even feel indulgent. Nevertheless, it is all the more important for parents to remain curious about themselves, strengthen supportive relationships, and cultivate new connections. Such an approach has a positive impact not only on the parents themselves but also on the family, especially their relationship with their children.



Stress Management**Are My Body and Mind Doing Okay?****Do You Know “Senior Year Syndrome”?**

Parents of high school seniors often share much of their children’s daily lives and are emotionally connected to them, sometimes experiencing stress as if they themselves had returned to their own exam year.

Is the child’s achievement the parent’s success? The “Senior Year Syndrome” Among Mothers of High School Seniors

Research shows that not only students but also their parents endure extreme anxiety and tension during the college entrance process, sometimes even reporting physical discomfort. According to the study, the intensity of parents’ emotional anxiety increases significantly once their child enters the final year of high school, peaking at the time of college acceptance announcements. Many parents reported experiencing physical symptoms ranging from mild headaches to back pain, indigestion, dry eyes, hair loss, and tinnitus during this period.

Managing Stress for a Healthy Body and Mind

A child’s college entrance process is a challenge for parents as well. A certain amount of stress can help maintain daily alertness and support a healthy life. However, parents often carry multiple pressures, including responsibility, household duties, child education, and work life. Stress isn’t eliminated—it’s managed.

When you feel stressed, try reading the following sentences aloud several times:

“Right now, I’m doing well enough.”

“I’ll focus on what I can do and let the rest go.”

“When this is all over, I’ll be stronger.”

“I trust myself and will move forward, one step at a time.”



[The Beginning of Change]



Creating Today's Self for Tomorrow's Me



Let's think concretely about the person we want to be in the future.

Ten years from now, I want to be as healthy as I am today and a more positive person.

Specifically, I want to be someone with good stamina and someone who laughs often.

For the future me, today's me takes action.

1. (Today) Record Gratitude and Patience

(Write down things you are grateful for and moments of patience from today.)

	Gratitude Today!	Patience Today!
1	Grateful to have even 10 minutes for a post-lunch walk!	Showed patience by sending my child to school without scolding after they overslept!
2	Grateful that the whole family could have dinner together!	Did not react emotionally to my spouse's curt tone!
3		

2. (This Week) Set Small Goals

(Create a plan that you can realistically accomplish.)

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Limit coffee to 1 cup a day					Wash the bedding	Clean the balcony

3. (This Month) Make an Exercise Plan

(Create a plan for exercises you can start immediately this month.)

1	Take the stairs instead of the elevator once a day (aim for at least 20 floors total)
2	Ride a stationary bike 3 times a week (Mon, Wed, Fri) for 40 minutes or more
3	

4. (3 Months) Start Something for Yourself

(Plan something you have wanted to try or do properly.)

1	Start something you've only thought about until now (clubs, reading, etc.)
2	
3	

5. (6 Months–1 Year) Record Your Change and Growth

(Meet the transformed you.)

	My Goals	My Transformations
1		
2		
3		



Leaving Footprints

In this chapter, we explored our personality, the background that has influenced who we are today, and the resources we possess, in order to better understand both “myself as an individual” and “myself as a parent.” Just as the person we were in the past shaped who we are now, we learned that the person we are today can shape our future self. Now, answer the following questions to assess your knowledge, skills, and attitudes.

Q1. I understand my personality type and the background that influenced my personality formation.



Q2. I can use the resources I have to solve problems that come my way.



Q3. I can effectively follow the stress management plan I have created.



By understanding yourself more deeply, you enrich your role as a parent. Designing your life based on your personality, background, strengths, and resources provides stability and love for your child. Exploring “myself as an individual” is a journey toward fulfilling “myself as a parent.” This self-understanding forms the foundation for a deeper and more meaningful relationship with your child.



Chapter 2

Passing Happiness On as a Parent



1. I'm Curious About Your Values

#Understanding Your Child's Disposition and Temperament,
#Empathic Communication, #Respecting and Exercising Your Child's Rights

2. How to Connect with Your Child through Conversation

#Managing Your Child's Mental Health, #Empathic Communication

Should parents be guides for their children?

That is one approach, but how about becoming a supporter who reflects and decides alongside your child? Do you know how to communicate in a way that helps your child move toward a "better future"? Become a parent who passes on the power of happiness, helping your child progress from today toward tomorrow.

[Me as a School Parent]

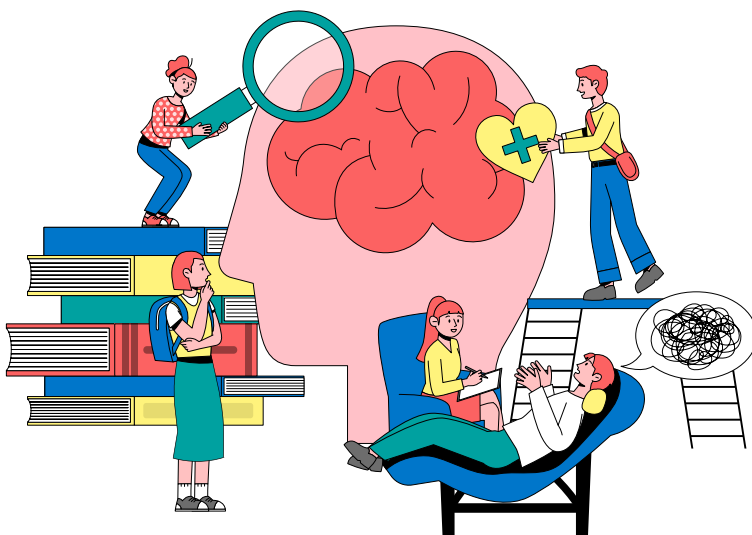
When It Gets Hard

Why are they so sensitive?

Parent: "How was your exam today? Did you do well?"

Child: "Gosh... can you stop asking? I'll manage it myself!"

My intention was simply curiosity and a desire for my child to do well, but repeated irritability from the child is upsetting and exhausting.



It's Okay, These Things Happen!

Adolescence is a critical period of brain development and emotional growth. During this time, the brain undergoes a "pruning" process, keeping only the necessary neural connections from an initially overproduced network. This temporarily reduces the function of the prefrontal cortex, which is responsible for rational thinking, leading to frequent emotional changes.

These rapid emotional fluctuations are a natural feature of adolescence. To help your child manage these changes effectively, it is important to listen to their voice, review how you communicate, and adjust your parent-child interaction accordingly.



Let's Check In with Ourselves

Below is a parenting checklist for adolescence. Read each item carefully. Mark O if you feel you are doing well in that area, or X if you feel you are not doing well.

O/X	Items
	Do not criticize your child's attitude in a coercive way. • Remember that adolescent behavior is part of the normal growth process.
	Focus on conversations with your child. • Put away phones and other distractions to engage fully in the discussion.
	Enjoy discussions or debates with your child. • Respect differences in opinion and create opportunities for logical expression.
	Respect your child's needs and desires. • Do not ignore your child's needs; work to negotiate through conversation.
	Know how to compromise with your child. • Develop collaborative approaches to solve problems together.
	Acknowledge your child's right to make decisions. • Give your child opportunities to choose and take responsibility for their actions.
	Make an effort to understand your child's emotions. • Listen sincerely and empathically without rushing to judgment.
	Reflect and express empathy for your child's feelings frequently. • Accept your child's feelings with statements like, "I can see why you feel that way."

Let's Think

- How much do you focus and listen when talking to your child?
- On a weekly basis, how many times do you talk to your child about their feelings and empathize with them?

1. I'm Curious About Your Values

#Understanding Your Child's Disposition and Temperament

#Empathic Communication

#Respecting and Exercising Your Child's Rights

[Take a Step Forward Today]

My high school son has loved drawing and crafting since he was young, and now he says he wants to become an artist. I, however, believe that a stable career is the most important in life, so I have been recommending a government job. My child responds, "I want to do what I love," and we feel frustrated because our discussions aren't narrowing the gap. How can we bridge this difference?

Understanding Your Child's Career Values

Have You Ever Explored Your Child's Values?



Assessing Career Values

Parents and children can be very different. Yet, since we are on the same team and need to plan the future cooperatively, we need a strategy. First, take a career values assessment to understand what values your child holds. Naturally, when a child designs a career aligned with their personal values, they are likely to experience greater satisfaction and achievement.

Scan the QR code to check your child's career values.



Career Values Assessment

The assessment uses a 5-point scale. To help your child's values emerge more clearly, please have them choose the response that best reflects their personal preference.

High School Student Career Values Assessment

Stability, Compensation, Work-Life Balance, Enjoyment, Belonging, Self-Development, Challenge, Influence, Social Contribution, Achievement, Social Recognition, Autonomy

* Record your child's career values assessment results

1) Top 3 Career Values with the Highest Scores, 2) Top 3 Career Values Your Child Considers Most Important

	1) Career Values with the Highest Scores	2) Career Values Your Child Considers Most Important
1		
2		
3		

Comparing Career Values

Parents and Children Can Be Very Different



Understanding Various Career Values

The career values assessment presents a total of 12 items. Read each carefully, and then write down your own priorities as a parent when you think about your child's future career.

Career Values		
1	Stability	Values being able to do the work they want consistently and securely.
2	Compensation	Values receiving economic rewards, such as salary, from work.
3	Work-Life Balance	Values achieving a balance between work and personal life.
4	Enjoyment	Values finding interest, fulfillment, and pleasure in work.
5	Belonging	Values being part of an organization and working with others.
6	Self-Development	Values personal growth and skill development through work.
7	Challenge	Values taking on new challenges without fear of failure.
8	Influence	Values having an impact on others and leading people.
9	Social Contribution	Values contributing to the happiness and welfare of others.
10	Achievement	Values having clear goals and accomplishing them.
11	Social Recognition	Values being acknowledged and respected by others.
12	Autonomy	Values making decisions about the content and environment of their work.
Parent's Career Values Priorities		
1st:	2nd:	3rd:
4th:	5th:	6th:

Understanding Your Child's Value Orientation

If career values are the “trees,” then value orientation is the “forest.” Depending on which values your child prioritizes, their overall life value orientation can be categorized into four types. Using the results of the career values assessment, let's explore which value orientation—Stability-Oriented, Meaning-Oriented, Change-Oriented, or Achievement-Oriented—your child exhibits.

Type	Key Values	Description
Stability-Oriented	• Stability • Compensation • Work-Life Balance	This type seeks a stable life through work. They may prioritize sufficient compensation for a secure life, prefer long-term employment in one organization, and aim for a well-organized life by maintaining a balance between work and personal life.
Meaning-Oriented	• Enjoyment • Belonging • Self-Development	This type looks to work to find meaning in life. They may feel a sense of existence through belonging to their future workplace, confirm the significance of their work through enjoyment, and pursue ongoing growth and development through self-improvement.
Change-Oriented	• Challenge • Influence • Social Contribution	This type values change over stability. They may seek constant new challenges at work, and aim to create positive change in society by influencing not only themselves but also others through their work.
Achievement-Oriented	• Achievement • Social Recognition • Autonomy	This type aims to accomplish something meaningful through their career. Achievement here is personal and internal; they seek both a sense of accomplishment and social recognition, while striving for autonomy to control their own life and work.



Exploring Careers Related to Your Child’s Value Orientation

Once you’ve looked at your child’s “forest,” it’s natural to start thinking about specific careers that might suit them. Review the representative careers for each value orientation, and then select the Top 3 careers that both you and your child find interesting. If there are careers not listed here, discuss them together and consider which value orientation they might fall under.

Next, compare your child’s preferred careers with your own preferences. For example, a change-oriented child who wants to be an artist may have different preferences than a stability-oriented parent who prefers a government job. Some career choices may align, and others may not.

Value Orientation	Related Careers
Stability-Oriented	Government official, teacher, accountant, banker, legal affairs specialist, office worker, etc.
Meaning-Oriented	Social worker, counselor, nurse, doctor, nonprofit activist, educator, etc.
Change-Oriented	Planner, entrepreneur, designer, IT developer, travel planner, journalist, etc.
Achievement-Oriented	Executive, lawyer, diplomat, athlete, sales professional, investment expert, etc.

Child’s Preferred Career Rankings		
1st:	2nd:	3rd:

Parent’s Preferred Career Rankings		
1st:	2nd:	3rd:



Sometimes parents present their own experiences as the “correct” path for their child. However, careers are the outcome of reflection that starts from a child’s career values (trees) and extends through their value orientation (forest). To help your child feel ownership over their life and make informed career choices, how about showing them various options and engaging in conversations to bridge differences between your perspectives?

2. How to Connect with Your Child through Conversation

#Managing Your Child's Mental Health

#Empathic Communication

[Take a Step Forward Today]

**Our Family's
"Happiness Gene"**

**Does my family have a
"happiness gene"?**



Do you feel that your child is currently happy? Has your child mentioned feeling happy recently?

**Conditions for Happy
Growth**

Professor Ed Diener, a leading expert in the science of happiness, found that "children who are happy at age 17 earn higher salaries at age 40." Research shows that happiness is closely related to various success factors, including marriage, income, and health. However, in some cultures—including Korea—the misleading logic of "good grades → success → happiness" is often emphasized. This approach can push children into relentless competition, so it is important to be cautious.

Checking Your "Happiness Gene"

The "happiness gene" is a symbolic term referring to situations where parents transmit the power of happiness to their children through positive words and actions. Below are examples of parent-child conversations that foster happiness versus those that do not.

	Happiness Gene Present in Parent-Child Conversation	Happiness Gene Lacking in Parent-Child Conversation
Child	"I got a really low math score this time. I really tried hard, and I feel so upset."	
Parent	"You really tried hard. This score doesn't reflect all your potential. What matters is your consistent effort."	"You say you tried, but look at the score! How are you going to get into college like this? Did you even try properly?"
Child	"It feels comforting that you recognize my effort."	"I tried so hard, but it didn't work!"
Parent	"That determination is amazing! Even though it was tough, you kept going without giving up. I'm really proud of you."	"If you had worked hard, you'd have gotten a better score. You didn't study properly. Pull yourself together from now on."
Characteristics	Empathizes with the child's emotions, praises effort, focuses on growth potential, and instills a positive mindset.	Ignores the child's emotions and focuses only on results. This approach can lead the child to develop negative self-perceptions and feel frustrated.

Checking Your “Love Language”

Pass on the Happiness Gene through the Language of Love



The most effective way to transmit the power of happiness to your child is through verbal expression. Before discussing visible outcomes like grades, reflect on whether you, as a parent, have created an emotional environment of support that allows your child to focus on learning through consistent encouragement and expression.

Being a Good Parent Before Being a School Parent

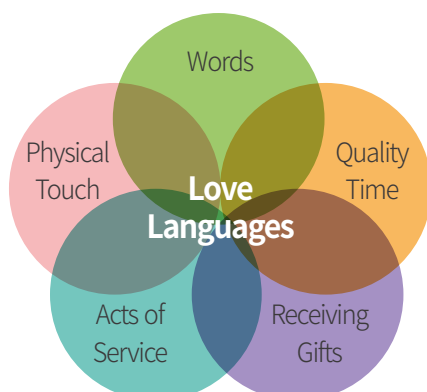
Think about the words you use most often with your child throughout the day. Compare the phrases you frequently used when your child was 2-3 years old, just beginning to understand your words, with those you use now that your child is in high school. Write down the words you most often said during each stage.

Past: Child Age 2-3	Present: High School Child
• •	• •

Do you remember when your child was taking their first steps and saying “Mom” or “Dad” for the first time? Back then, you likely praised even the smallest growth unconditionally. As your child has grown, are you now focusing mostly on outcomes rather than the process, offering praise conditionally? Let’s focus on being good parents first, providing sufficient expression and support to your high school child, rather than emphasizing grades above all else.

Passing on the Happiness Gene

One way to pass on the happiness gene is through family conversation and the “Language of Love.” Psychologist Dr. Gary Chapman explains that people give and receive love in different ways. He identifies five “love languages”:



- Expressing recognition and appreciation verbally
- Spending meaningful time together
- Giving and receiving presents
- Doing helpful things for each other
- Showing affection through touch

Checking Your Family's "Love Language"

What kind of "love languages" does your family have? Read each line of the checklist below and reflect on which love languages your family tends to use. Mark the love language your family is **most confident** in with ♥ and **least confident** in with ★.

Five Love Languages	Mark (♥,★)	Examples
Words of Affirmation		• Recognize even small efforts
		• Convey consistent sincerity and trust
		• Praise the process rather than just the outcome
		• Be consistent when giving recognition
Quality Time		• Spend time fully focused on the other person
		• Make eye contact, listen, and communicate
		• Show genuine attention and convey a sense of togetherness
		• Avoid indifference or distracted behavior
Receiving Gifts		• Prepare gifts with the recipient in mind
		• Consider the family's needs in daily life
		• Do not expect or demand anything in return
		• Communicate the meaning of the gift sincerely
Acts of Service		• Willingly help through actions rather than words
		• Act fully for the benefit of the other person
		• Sacrifice your time and energy with joy
		• Avoid forcing your child to acknowledge your actions
Physical Touch		• Express parental love through touch
		• Use forms of touch that your child prefers, not just what you like
		• Understand that appropriate touch in the family can influence your child's future romantic and marital relationships

Practicing the “Love Language”

Every family may be stronger in some love languages and weaker in others. Let’s create a plan to practice your family’s love languages. First, share the love languages you identified earlier with your child. Through conversation, decide together which love languages each family member wants to give and receive. Then, make a concrete action plan for practicing them.

Examples / Quality Time: Go for a family walk in the park every Sunday

Physical Touch: Hug your child every morning

Who?	What?	How?	When?
Family Member	Love Language	Action to Practice	Frequency
Mom and Dad	Words of Affirmation	Say one compliment to the child each day	3 times per week



What love language does your child prefer? This may reflect the expressions of love they most want to hear from you. By consistently practicing your child’s preferred love language, you build a warmer and stronger parent-child relationship. It’s not difficult: Speak the words you’ve been holding in your heart, letting your child hear them, and express physical affection, such as hugs, so your warmth is felt as love. Even small, intentional actions accumulate over time to strengthen your bond.

Making the “Love Language” a Habit **Start Now!**



High school students often experience psychological pressure from academics and stress in peer relationships, which can lead to emotional instability. During this time, children learn how to manage difficult emotions and develop emotional regulation skills through their parents’ words and actions. The language and behaviors shared within the family can serve as the emotional roots for your child, making them extremely important.

Habituating the “Love Language”

To convey positive love languages to your child, it is important for parents to practice positive words and actions first. Small, consistent actions by parents accumulate over time, and children naturally imitate these behaviors, leading to positive changes. This is called parent modeling. If practicing positive parent modeling and making love languages a habit feels challenging, try the following 3-step process along with the examples below:

<Steps to Make the “Love Language” a Habit>

1. Reflect on Your Emotions	At the end of each day, reflect on how you felt and consider the sources of any difficult emotions. Demonstrating self-awareness and emotional management is important for your child to learn.
	Example: “Today was really busy, but seeing you smile gave me energy.”
2. Practice Positive Expression	Directly express positive feelings to your child, and offer praise or words of gratitude.
	Example: “I’m so happy that you tried your best to finish your homework!”
3. Share Emotions Together	Set aside time for the family to share the emotions experienced throughout the day—joy, sadness, anger, etc. Parents should lead by honestly sharing their own emotions to encourage children to open up.
	Example: “What was the happiest moment for you today?”

[The Beginning of Change]

Recall the steps of “Making the Love Language a Habit.” Check your usual words at each step, refer to the examples, and rewrite them into more positive, loving expressions. Then, share these revised words with your child, accompanied by a warm smile.

1. Reflect on Your Emotions

Previous Language	→	Positive Love Language
When I'm angry at my child		When I'm angry at my child
Example: "If that's how you're going to be, forget it all!"		Example: "Let's calmly talk about what we each want."
was what I said.		is what I will say.

Previous Language	→	Positive Love Language
When I'm tired or stressed		When I'm tired or stressed
Example: "I'm so busy with work, and now you're making it harder!"		
was what I said.		is what I will say.

2. Practice Positive Expression

Previous Language	→	Positive Love Language
When looking at my child's report card		When looking at my child's report card
Example: "Carelessness is still a skill. Write down your mistakes in the notebook."		Example: "Good job taking the test! Learning from mistakes matters more than the score. You're doing well!"
was what I said.		is what I will say.

Previous Language	→	Positive Love Language
When my child hasn't finished homework		When my child hasn't finished homework
Example: "No phone until your homework is done. Hurry up!"		
was what I said.		is what I will say.

3. Share Emotions Together

Previous Language	→	Positive Love Language
When my child feels upset		When my child feels upset
Example: "Don't cry, speak properly. I can't understand otherwise."		
was what I said.		is what I will say.



TIPS. Building New Connections

Think back to your own childhood and consider the words you wished you had heard from your parents. How do you think hearing those words would have made you feel?



Leaving Footprints

In this chapter, we learned that understanding your child's career values and preferences and recognizing the words and actions they appreciate helps parents provide empathy and emotional support. This support forms the foundation for a child's stable growth and a successful future. Use the following questions to review what you've learned and reflect on how to continuously apply it at home.

Q1. Why is it important to understand your child's career values and value orientation?

- ① To persuade your child to choose a job you prefer
- ② To understand your child's career direction and explore suitable jobs together
- ③ To make your child take full responsibility for career choices on their own

Q2. When communicating with your child using their love language, what is most important?

- ① Communicate using the love language your child prefers
- ② Express love in the parent's own way
- ③ Focus only on words, without considering actions

Q3. Why is it important to share love languages within the family and consistently show them to your child?

- ① To quickly change the child's behavior
- ② To foster positive coping attitudes through positive parent modeling
- ③ To relieve parental stress

High school is a critical period for building emotional resilience before adulthood. As your child sets sail into the wide sea of life, providing a strong anchor of love through consistent, positive love-language practices will help them face strong winds with confidence and stability.



* Correct answers: 1-②, 2-①, 3-②

Chapter 3

Becoming an Expert in Child Nurturing



1. Balancing Academics and Emotional Well-Being

#Supporting Self-Directed Learning, #Providing Motivation for Learning,
#Life Guidance and Behavior Management

2. A Changing World: Life in the Digital Age

#Safe Digital Use Guidance

The journey of parenthood offers unexpected gifts of learning and growth. As your child grows, changes, and matures into an adult, you also develop expertise in nurturing and education. Together, you will navigate challenges, stumble, and rise again. This shared path becomes a map of growth, drawn by both parent and child.

[Me as a School Parent]

When It Gets Hard

My child wants to relax on weekends by using their phone.
I know they work hard at school and at extra classes during the week,
yet seeing them on their phone can feel frustrating when their grades aren't as high as I hope.
It may seem like they don't value studying as much as I do.



It's Okay, These Things Happen!

High school is a critical period when academics and career planning become increasingly important, and when children are growing toward independence. Because of the pressure they face, children need adequate rest and leisure, but parents can feel frustrated when their child's effort seems insufficient or results don't meet expectations.

Often, differences arise between parents and children because each views learning from their own perspective.

For this reason, it's important for parents to reflect on their own educational beliefs through conversations with their child and to make an effort to understand the child's thoughts on learning and the values they consider important.



Let's Check In with Ourselves

Checking and Reframing Your Educational Beliefs: My View of Studying, Your View of Studying

Reflecting on your own beliefs about education can help you communicate more effectively with your child and find compromises when opinions differ. What does “studying” mean to you and to your child? Together, mark your views along the scale below.

A student's primary duty is studying, and grades determine the future.		Diverse experiences, talents, and aptitudes are more important than grades.
For high school students, private academies and extra tutoring are essential.		Excessive tutoring can cause stress; self-directed learning is key.
Phones and games distract from studying and are a waste of time.		When used appropriately, they can aid learning and help relieve stress.

Let's Think

- What were the things your parents often said to you as a high school student? Did these words influence your own beliefs about education?
- What are the differences between your high school experience and your child's? How should your educational beliefs adapt to these changes?

1. Balancing Academics and Emotional Well-Being

#Supporting Self-Directed Learning

#Providing Motivation for Learning

#Life Guidance and Behavior Management

[Take a Step Forward Today]

My child only began to study independently in high school and may not yet know which study methods suit them best. I notice them hopping from one subject to another without seeing much improvement. They were so anxious during the first mock exam that their hands shook, and they couldn't finish all the answers. How can I help my child?

Discovering Your Child's Learning Style and Tailored Strategy

Your Teen's Learning DNA: Find the Study Method That Works



Does your child prefer making a study plan in advance? Do they work better in a quiet environment, or with a little background noise? Understanding your teen's learning type early allows you to guide them more effectively.

Discovering Your Child's Learning Style

Learning styles can be divided into Thinking (Analytical vs. Holistic), Learning Orientation (Self-directed vs. Socially-oriented), and Behavioral Control (Rational vs. Emotional). Reflect on your child's habits and check the type that best fits them.

Areas		Description	Mark
Thinking Style	Analytical	• Learns by memorizing details carefully before understanding the whole.	
	Holistic	• Understands concepts by seeing the big picture rather than focusing on details.	
Learning Orientation	Self-Directed	• Focuses on what studying means for themselves, their reasons, and methods.	
	Socially-Oriented	• Connects studying to others and considers how results meet others' expectations.	

Areas		Description	Mark
Behavioral Control	Rational	• Stays on track with a systematic plan, prioritizing organization over temporary feelings to maintain study focus.	
	Emotional	• Uses their emotions constructively, adjusting their learning approach based on how they feel.	

Estimate Your Child’s Learning Type

Which learning style does your child follow? Learning types are categorized according to thinking style, learning orientation, and behavioral regulation, resulting in eight possible types. Use your earlier notes to make an educated guess about your child’s type.

Type	Thinking Style	Learning Orientation	Behavioral Control
Platonic	Holistic	Self-directed	Rational
Gaudi	Holistic	Self-directed	Emotional
Roosevelt	Holistic	Social	Rational
Spielberg	Holistic	Social	Emotional
Marie Curie	Analytical	Self-directed	Rational
Schubert	Analytical	Self-directed	Emotional
Sherlock Holmes	Analytical	Social	Rational
Nightingale	Analytical	Social	Emotional

Try This

Learning Type Diagnostic Test

Check your guess with the EBSi Learning Type Diagnostic Test. It only takes about 10 minutes and provides learning strategies tailored to your child. Review the results with your child to understand how their learning type influences study habits.



EBSi Learning Type Diagnostic Test

Summarize your child's learning type and effective study strategies based on test results.

Learning Type	Thinking Style	Learning Orientation	Behavioral Control
() Type			
Study Strategies	• When studying alone, set a 50-minute timer, study for the allotted time, and then take a 10-minute break. • •		

Learning Motivation

The Driving Force Behind the Learning Journey: An Unyielding Mind



We have learned that each student has a unique learning type and that strategies should be tailored accordingly. But above all, the key question for meaningful learning is: How can one gain the motivation to achieve goals? Here, we introduce “grit,” the force that helps children sustain motivation and take ownership of their learning.

Understanding Grit

Grit is the passion and perseverance needed to achieve long-term goals over several years. Individuals with high grit can dedicate sustained effort to challenging goals and do not easily give up when facing obstacles. Conversely, those with low grit tend to change goals frequently and struggle to maintain consistent effort.



The Power of Passion and Perseverance (Grit)*

* TED. *The Power of Passion and Perseverance: Grit*. 2013.

https://www.ted.com/talks/angelajee_duckworth_grit_the_power_of_passion_and_perseverance?subtitle=ko



Growing Grit Through Effort and Practice

Grit is not innate like intelligence; it can be cultivated through effort and practice. Key factors that foster grit include: curiosity, exploring areas of personal interest independently; emotional regulation, managing stress and maintaining positive emotions; and parenting support, providing warm guidance while respecting the child's autonomy.

Parents Who Nurture Grit

While a child's own effort is essential for developing grit, the way parents guide daily life also plays a critical role. Let's check whether you are fostering grit in your child. Read the practical strategies below and mark ☒ for the items you are practicing.

Practical Ways to Foster Your Child's Grit	
☐	Did I offer warm words and encouragement to help my child take small acts of courage today? • Remember: Family support helps children maintain positive emotions and provides a foundation for managing stress and anxiety.
☐	Did I encourage my child to get enough exercise? • Keep in mind: For grit to grow, balancing study and physical activity in daily life is essential for both mental and physical development.
☐	When my child said studying was difficult, did I respond with empathy and concrete guidance? • "It's hard" doesn't always mean "I don't want to do it." Acknowledge that studying can be challenging and commend their perseverance while offering practical alternatives.
☐	Does my child perceive me as a parent who respects their learning interests and autonomy? • If not, encourage them to start learning in areas they are genuinely interested in. This is where grit begins to grow.
☐	Am I making specific efforts to help my child build positive relationships with teachers? • Positive relationships with teachers boost academic confidence and a sense of belonging at school, which supports the development of grit.

Test Anxiety

Avoiding the Pit vs. Finding Your Way Out



The word "test" alone can make anyone's heart race. In school, tests are necessary to check whether students have understood what they have learned. We call this process a "test." Some semesters have at least two tests, and sometimes there's even one every month. How well is your child coping with this?



Test Anxiety Self-Check

A certain level of tension is necessary for students to perform according to their effort. However, if your child experiences test anxiety so strongly that it feels like a serious threat, they may be unable to demonstrate their true ability. Through a self-check for test anxiety, let's understand the degree of anxiety your child experiences during exams.

Test Anxiety Self-Check: TAI-K (Test Anxiety Inventory-Korea) Self-Assessment Items (1-Not at all, 2-Slightly agree, 3-Agree, 4-Strongly agree)

	Questions	Points			
1	I worry more before an important test.	1	2	3	4
2	I feel embarrassed in front of my family or others if I fail or get a low score.	1	2	3	4
3	I am worried about being scolded by my parents if my test results are poor.	1	2	3	4
4	My hands shake during tests.	1	2	3	4
5	The more I study for a test, the more cluttered my mind feels.	1	2	3	4
6	I can't concentrate during a test because I keep thinking I might do poorly.	1	2	3	4
7	During important tests, I feel my heart racing.	1	2	3	4
8	I get so nervous during tests that I forget things I actually know.	1	2	3	4
9	I feel afraid of having to take a test.	1	2	3	4
10	While taking a test, I think other students will do better than me.	1	2	3	4
11	During important tests, my stomach feels strange from nervousness.	1	2	3	4
12	I feel extremely tense just before seeing my test results.	1	2	3	4
13	I feel like I will keep failing in important tests.	1	2	3	4
14	I worry more about tests in subjects I am not good at.	1	2	3	4
15	I fear that poor test results will make teachers not recognize my abilities.	1	2	3	4
16	Worrying about test scores prevents me from performing well.	1	2	3	4
17	I lose motivation to study because I think I cannot get good grades no matter how hard I try.	1	2	3	4
18	During a test, I get so nervous that it is hard to absorb the questions.	1	2	3	4
19	Even when I have prepared well, I still get nervous when the test begins.	1	2	3	4
20	While taking a test, I worry whether I can get into the school I want in the future.	1	2	3	4
21	Even if I have prepared enough, I worry I might still perform poorly on the test.	1	2	3	4
22	I get anxious thinking I haven't studied what I should have.	1	2	3	4
23	Because of worrying about the test, I have trouble studying or sleeping the night before.	1	2	3	4
24	I feel like I am not a very capable person.	1	2	3	4
25	I feel very anxious and restless while taking a test.	1	2	3	4

Your Child's Total Anxiety Score : [] Points

※ Source: Kim, Moon-Joo. "Development of the Korean Form of the Test Anxiety Inventory." *Journal of the Korean Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry*, 2(1), 32-42, 1991.

Interpretation Guidelines for Test Anxiety Scores

Score 30 or below	Your child experiences little stress related to tests. However, be aware that being too relaxed may reduce focus and efficiency.
Score 31-50	Test anxiety is at an average level, so there is no need for excessive concern.
Score 51-74	Tension and anxiety may negatively affect academic performance. It is important to actively learn strategies to reduce test stress and overcome anxiety.
Score 75 or above	Test anxiety is very high, making it difficult for your child to perform at their best. Professional counseling or treatment from a qualified specialist may be necessary.

Strategies to Overcome Test Anxiety

If it can't be avoided, it must be faced. For children who experience high anxiety and worry about exams, simply saying things like: *"Relax, it's okay."* or *"If you try your best, there's nothing to worry about."* is usually not very effective.



President John F. Kennedy relieved stress by swimming or chatting with his siblings. President Abraham Lincoln walked the White House halls while singing to calm himself. Here are three strategies designed for highly anxious individuals. If your child suffers from high test anxiety, consider which of these strategies might best suit them.

1. Meditation and Relaxation Techniques	• Watch mindfulness meditation videos (for example, “Raisin Meditation”). • Practice physical relaxation exercises: take deep breaths, clench and slowly release fists, tightly close your eyes and then gently open them, or other simple movements to release tension.
2. Visualization and Positive Self-Talk	• Vividly imagine the test situation while repeating positive statements to yourself, such as: “My efforts are not in vain. I will achieve results according to my preparation.” • If the test triggers strong anxiety, start by imagining a low-pressure situation (like a short quiz) and gradually work up to imagining a high-pressure exam (like the college entrance exam). • Calmly think through potential issues—marking errors, time constraints, or other challenges—and visualize yourself handling them successfully.
3. Writing Strategies	• When anxiety arises during test preparation, express your thoughts and images in a “worry journal” with words or drawings. Over 1-2 weeks, you may notice recurring worries, helping you understand your anxiety patterns. • Expressive writing: about 10 minutes before a test, write down your honest thoughts and feelings about the exam repeatedly. This practice allows you to confront your anxiety and objectively observe your reactions.

Although these methods may seem simple, if they fit your child’s style, anxiety can often diminish more easily than expected. The key is not to ignore anxiety, but to face it through various strategies and gain experience managing it successfully.

2. A Changing World: Life in the Digital Age

#Safe Digital Use
Guidance

[Take a Step Forward Today]

Watching my child constantly glued to their smartphone, I sometimes wonder what kind of digital world they will grow up in. Even as a high school student, seeing them use AI platform apps so freely is impressive. At the same time, I worry: could they become addicted to their phone, or get caught up in risky situations? I don't know much about AI myself, so I feel that trusting my child to handle it well and simply observing is all I can do.

Growing as a Digital Citizen

Developing Digital Skills

Do you know what children these days are called? Because they have been surrounded by smartphones since birth, they are called “**digital natives**.” True to the name, students today often use AI platforms like ChatGPT both for studying and for leisure.



TV programs and online sources often emphasize that, in the era of the Fourth Industrial Revolution, citizens must know how to use AI. However, parents naturally worry: Is my child using AI tools effectively? Safely? Could they be exposed to crime or unethical content? To help your child grow into a **responsible digital citizen with a healthy ethical compass**, it is important for parents to understand what they need to know about the digital world.

What It Means to Be a Citizen in a Digital Society

What does a healthy digital citizen look like?

- Someone who respects the rights, intellectual property, and privacy of others online.
- Someone who communicates and empathizes with fellow citizens using diverse digital channels.
- Someone who can distinguish advertisements and fake news, avoids mindless sharing, and thinks critically.
- Someone who prioritizes their physical, emotional, and mental health while using digital tools.
- Someone who uses digital tools to collaborate effectively with others.
- Someone who can control their usage and not be overly dependent on digital tools.

Digital Technology as a Tool for Crime

Digital technology can revolutionize human life, but it can also become a tool for new types of crime. In other words, digital tools are a double-edged sword—the outcome depends entirely on how they are used. Let's take a closer look at the misuse of digital technology that could affect our children, as well as digital crimes that cannot be ignored.



1. Digital Addiction

Digital addiction refers to an excessive dependence on digital devices such as the internet and smartphones, which negatively affects academics, relationships, and daily life. A survey of 125,000 adolescents* revealed that approximately 17.7% are at risk of overdependence on the internet and smartphones. On average, adolescents spend about 7.1 hours on weekdays and 9.1 hours on weekends online. Clearly, internet addiction among adolescents is a serious issue. How about your child—**is their smartphone usage under control?**

* Ministry of Gender Equality and Family. *Results of the 2024 Survey on Youth Media Usage Habits*. 2024.

2. Deepfake

Can you tell the difference between a real photo and an AI-generated one? Which one is real?



Surprisingly, there are no real people in these photos. They are all AI-generated. Deepfakes use artificial intelligence to create highly realistic images or voices, producing fake content. This technology is often misused for spreading false information, creating sexual content, or conducting voice phishing scams. In fact, there has been a sharp rise in social crimes where perpetrators use photos obtained via social media of former classmates to produce deepfake sexual exploitation material and then threaten the victims. **It is essential for parents to ensure that their children have a proper understanding of deepfakes and the potential dangers associated with them.**

3. Digital Sexual Crimes

Digital sexual crimes involve using digital devices to produce or distribute illegal sexual content or to violate someone's privacy. Among young people, sharing videos or photos via social media or messaging apps is common, which makes such crimes frequent.



A significant concern is that most teenage victims do not report the crime to their parents, which allows the harm to escalate. Representative crimes include: forcing minors to create sexual exploitation material and distributing it, as in the “Nth Room” case; and blackmailing victims using sexual videos or images to demand money, also known as “cam phishing” or “body cam phishing.”

4. Confirmation Bias and Filter Bubbles

Confirmation bias is the tendency to seek out only the evidence that supports one's existing beliefs. Filter bubbles occur when internet algorithms show users content tailored to their interests, which may lead to repeated exposure to biased or one-sided information.

What Are These Two People's Interests?



Recently, YouTube and other social media platforms use sophisticated algorithms to continuously recommend content that matches users' interests. However, these systems can hinder the acquisition of objective and balanced information. By exposing users only to certain viewpoints, they can lead to confirmation bias and filter bubble effects, limiting access to diverse perspectives.

AI Platforms**Welcome to the World of Generative AI!**

You’ve probably heard a lot about Generative AI lately—but do you know exactly what it is? Many parents feel uncertain about what AI actually means, whether they can use it themselves, or how to introduce it into their children’s learning. Let’s take a look at what Generative AI is and explore the AI tools that students commonly use today.

**What is AI, and what does “generative” mean?**

AI (Artificial Intelligence) refers to computer programs designed to think logically like humans by processing vast amounts of data. The term generative means that the AI can create new content based on existing data, depending on the user’s input or specific conditions.

**Can AI help with studying?**

Research continues to show that AI can be beneficial for learning—but what truly matters is how it is used. When used not as a “box of ready-made answers,” but as a guided and self-directed learning tool under a teacher’s instruction, AI can serve as a valuable educational resource.

**How does AI support learning?**

One common example is personalized learning. AI-based platforms such as ChatGPT or EBS Danchoo analyze a student’s level and progress to offer customized learning experiences based on extensive data.

Exploring Generative AI Platforms

Generative AI platforms make use of advanced technology to perform a wide variety of tasks such as writing, note-taking, data analysis, drawing, and creating presentation materials. Below are some of the most actively used AI tools today that can serve as effective learning aids for students.

Name	QR Code	Description	Main Features
 ChatGPT		Provides answers in a conversational format, similar to talking with someone. It can generate text and offer information or writing assistance.	Text generation, conversation, writing support, information retrieval
 Canva		Enables easy creation of presentations, logos, and social media graphics using AI technology—no design experience required.	Presentation creation, graphic design
 EBS DanChoo		Short for “Step-by-Step Learning Recommendation,” this Korean AI platform recommends personalized learning content based on a student’s level and learning style.	Diagnostic assessments, personalized learning recommendations
 Classting		Provides a space for teachers, students, and parents to communicate, with AI-supported recommendations, assessments, and collaboration features.	Classroom communication, teacher-student-parent interaction
 Notion AI		Supports document writing, organization, content generation, search, analysis, and idea structuring. Excellent for note-taking and project management.	Writing, task organization, structured note-taking
 Midjourney		Creates digital art or images based on written descriptions. Useful for creative projects and visual design.	Image generation and editing, creative and design projects

[The Beginning of Change]

“Learning Vision Board” is an activity where parents and children visualize their learning goals and dreams together. By creating a vision board, parents and children can see the direction of their learning and discuss healthy digital habits needed to reach those goals. This is especially helpful for high school students, who often struggle to manage their screen time. A visualized vision board can help them practice self-directed planning—so try making one together with your child!

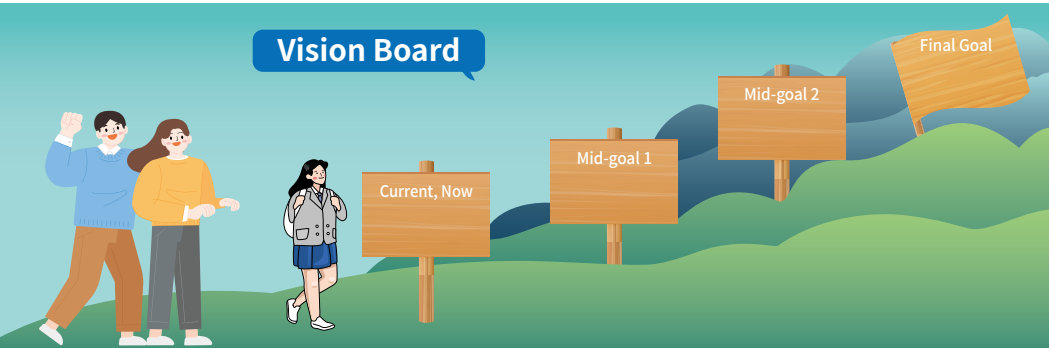
How to Create

1) Write your desired career or educational goal after graduation in the “Final Goal” section.

2) In the “Current” section, write your current situation or abilities related to your goal, such as grades, career plans, or skills.

3) Set intermediate goals to bridge the gap between your current status and your final goal.

4) In the table below, list the digital habits (of your child or your family) that might interfere with achieving the goal, along with ideas for improvement. The more specific you are about how and when devices are used, the better.



	Digital Habits Hindering Progress	Usage Time	Improvement Plan
Example	Checking social media before bed	2 hours	Keep phones in a “phone box” in the living room before bedtime, or set a one-hour phone limit before sleeping
1			
2			



Leaving Footprints

In this section, we explored your child's learning style, motivation for self-directed learning, and ways to cope with test anxiety. We also discussed the qualities and efforts needed to grow as a responsible digital citizen. Now, let's think about what parents can understand and practice to help their children use digital technology in a healthy and responsible way—and check your understanding through the O/X quiz and case quiz below.

	O/X Quiz Questions	O/X
1	A digital citizen thinks critically about fake news and does not share it carelessly.	
2	A digital citizen actively shares others' intellectual property and personal information in the name of the public's right to know.	
3	The filter bubble is an algorithmic phenomenon that helps users collect a wide range of information.	
4	Digital sexual crimes do not include acts of stealing personal information online.	
5	Deepfake refers to fake images or videos created by combining real photos.	
6	Generative AI is a technology that creates new content by learning from existing data.	
7	ChatGPT is a generative AI tool that provides text creation and conversation functions.	
8	EBS Danchoo is a platform that recommends learning content suited to a student's academic level.	

Case Quiz: Read the following cases of AI misuse and write down which example from the list below each case belongs to.		Answer
<List> Digital Sexual Crime (Sextortion), Confirmation Bias & Filter Bubble, Deepfake		
1	Se-ra recently discovered an interesting AI app and thought it would be fun to play a prank on her friends. One day, she took a photo of her classmate Hye-yeon making an awkward face and used AI to seamlessly combine Hye-yeon's face with a famous celebrity's interview video. She then uploaded the video on social media with the caption, "Hye-yeon, when did you debut as a star?"	
2	Hyeon-u has an online girlfriend he met through a game, though they've never met in person. One day, she asked, "Send me just one photo so I can see your face whenever I miss you." Hyeon-u sent his picture without much thought. Soon, she began asking for more revealing photos. After he sent a shirtless picture, her attitude suddenly changed. "I'll send this to your friends if you don't pay me." She continued to threaten him for money.	
3	Ga-yeong enjoys watching the news and cares about social issues. She often gets information from YouTube and social media. One day, she came across a certain video, and afterward, similar videos kept autoplaying. Before long, her feed was filled with videos sharing the same perspective. Gradually, she developed strong political beliefs and began reacting harshly in class discussions toward classmates who disagreed, saying, "You're all watching fake news!"	

O/X Quiz Answers

1	O - A responsible digital citizen thinks critically about fake news and avoids sharing it recklessly.
2	X - Respecting intellectual property and privacy means protecting others' rights, not exposing them.
3	X - A filter bubble limits diverse perspectives rather than expanding them.
4	X - Digital sex crimes include the misuse of personal information online.
5	O - Deepfake refers to fake images or videos created by combining real photos.
6	O - Generative AI is a technology that produces new content based on what it has learned from existing data.
7	O - ChatGPT is a generative AI tool designed for text creation and conversation.
8	O - EBS Danchoo helps students by recommending learning materials suited to their level.

Case Quiz Answers

1	Artificial intelligence can now create strikingly realistic faces and voices that don't actually exist. This technology, called deepfake, can be used creatively but also dangerously. It is sometimes exploited for spreading false information, making sexual content, or even for scams like voice phishing.
2	Digital sex crimes include producing or distributing explicit content without consent, or invading someone's privacy using digital tools. One serious example is "body cam phishing," where offenders threaten victims with sexual images or videos to extort money.
3	When we only look for information that supports what we already believe, it is called confirmation bias. Online, algorithms can reinforce this by showing us similar content over and over, forming a filter bubble that narrows our view of the world.



For high school students, both learning and emotional challenges tend to be self-directed, yet they are not matters the student should face alone—they must be addressed together as a family. The same applies to developing digital citizenship. Please help your child understand that while they should make their own decisions, they must also remain open to advice from family and those around them, and take responsibility for the choices they make. Be a strong source of support so your child can discover their own potential and continue to grow.

Chapter 4

Partnering with School for Your Child's Future



1. Cooperating with Teachers

#Participating in School Education, #Communicating and Cooperating with School Communities,
#Forming a Parent-Teacher Partnership, #Cooperative Communication,
#Trusting and Respecting Teachers, #Utilizing Local Community Resources

2. Digesting Educational Policies

#Understanding the Curriculum, #Understanding Educational Changes

Even after more than ten years of being a parent and sending your child to school, you may still be curious about their school life. When they were younger, your child would readily share the day's events, but now they often keep quiet and adopt a defensive attitude, signaling that you shouldn't pry. It can be difficult to know how to satisfy this curiosity. There are many things you may wonder about, from classroom behavior and academic performance to school activities and college preparation.

Shall we take a closer look at the high school where your child spends half of their day?

[Me as a School Parent]

When It Gets Hard

How much attention should I pay to my child's school life?

You may wonder whether your child is managing school well. You want to actively support their career and college preparation, but it can feel overwhelming to know how to collaborate with their homeroom teacher. News reports often discuss changes in the high school curriculum and university admissions, making it difficult to know where to start.



It's Okay, These Things Happen!

High school is a critical period when your child begins envisioning their future. However, balancing academics while preparing independently for careers and college is challenging. At this time, parental interest and support can be a significant source of strength for your child.

Changes in career guidance, college admissions, and educational policies can feel overwhelming for many parents. Therefore, it is crucial to seek support from the school and teachers and work together to foster your child's growth.



Let's Check In with Ourselves

The checklist below is designed to help parents reflect on their perceptions of the school and teachers. Read each item carefully and mark those that align with your thoughts.

Parent Perception Checklist: School and Teachers	
☐	I am generally interested in my child's school life.
☐	I consider myself a parent who trusts the school and respects the teachers.
☐	I am well-informed about my child's school curriculum, academic calendar, and subjects.
☐	I feel comfortable consulting teachers about my child's career path.
☐	I know about institutions outside of school that can provide psychological or emotional support to my child if needed.
☐	I am aware of parent participation activities at my child's school and actively take part in them.

Reread the checklist and reflect on your attitudes as a parent who entrusts education to the school. Consider how you can serve as a supportive partner in your child's education.

Let's Think

- How do you usually feel about teachers?
- Do you respect and trust teachers, and recognize them as partners to collaborate with?
- Do you make an effort to stay informed about recent education policies and utilize resources outside the school?

1. Cooperating with Teachers

#Participating in School Education

#Communicating and Cooperating with School Communities

#Forming a Parent-Teacher Partnership

#Cooperative Communication

#Trusting and Respecting Teachers

#Utilizing Local Community Resources

[Take a Step Forward Today]

Becoming a high school parent often brings new concerns. A parent-teacher conference is coming up, but I'm unsure what to discuss—my child hasn't decided on a career path, and we haven't talked much recently. What should I ask the teacher?

Parent-Teacher Conferences

The First Step to Effective Communication



Understanding Types of Parent-Teacher Conferences

	Parent-Teacher Conference Week	Ad Hoc Conferences
Purpose	Comprehensive, regular discussions about the student's academic progress and school life	Problem-solving focused consultations for specific issues or situations
Operation	Scheduled at the start of the semester via notice; time slots are limited and require prior reservation	Scheduled flexibly based on mutual agreement; can be held in person or by phone

Topics to Discuss During Conferences

Have you ever been unsure about what topics to discuss with teachers during a parent-teacher conference? Let's explore the essential topics that high school parents should cover when meeting with teachers.

Discussing your child's academic performance

Ask specifically about your child's academic achievement and learning habits. Request feedback on strengths and weaknesses and ways to improve learning attitudes. Inquire about managing academic stress and strategies for motivating your child.

Discussing your child's psychological well-being	Parents may discuss their child's emotional state, the influence of the home environment, and strategies for providing emotional support. You may also request referrals to psychological assessments or counseling services if needed.
Discussing career and college planning	High school is a critical period for career and college planning. Parents can ask about suitable majors based on the student's grades and interests, as well as strategies tailored to different college admission procedures.
Discussing peer relationships and school life	If you are concerned about your child's peer relationships, inquire whether they actively and positively participate in classroom activities and clubs. You can also discuss behavior, attendance, and participation in extracurricular activities as they relate to college admissions.

Q&A.

What Should I Do? Case Study: Considering Dropping Out

Q. Parent's Concern

My child recently said that studying doesn't suit them, and last year, they suddenly said they want to become a rapper. They want to learn rap professionally and are even considering dropping out this year. As a parent, I am very worried and unsure if dropping out is the right decision.

A. Consider the "School Dropout Reconsideration Program"!

Your concerns are understandable. Dropping out is a major life decision, so it should be made after careful consideration. The "School Dropout Reconsideration Program" provides students at risk of leaving school up to seven weeks of deliberation, along with professional counseling and programs, so they can think carefully about whether to discontinue their studies. After the deliberation period, if the student decides to leave school, they can receive various support at a support center for out-of-school youth, including counseling, GED preparation, and career experiences. According to Article 15 of the Act on the Support for Out-of-School Youth, schools provide the student's and guardian's name, gender, birth date, contact information, or address to the center. Nearby centers can be found at www.1388.go.kr or by calling 1388 (add your local area code).

Important Notes for Parent-Teacher Conferences

1. Anyone Can Request a Consultation	Any parent may request a consultation. Except in special circumstances, the contents of the consultation are strictly confidential, so you can consult with peace of mind.
2. Scheduling is Required	Consultations are generally conducted outside class hours. Please coordinate in advance with the teacher regarding the time and method. However, career guidance teachers or counseling teachers may also be available during class hours, so feel free to contact them.
3. Consultations May Not Be Possible in Certain Cases	• If the purpose, time, or method has not been agreed upon in advance • If the request is outside the teacher's professional scope • If the request is made outside of working hours

Partnership with Teachers

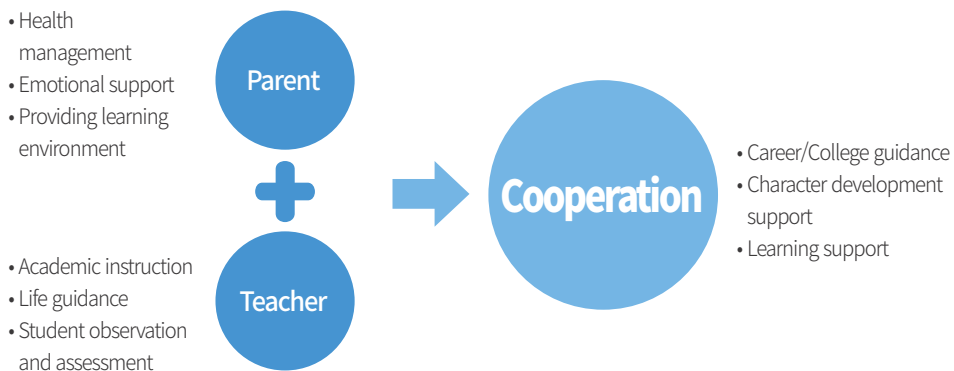
Building a Collaborative Relationship



Parents and teachers share the same goal: supporting the learning and career development of children. However, the roles of parents and teachers are distinct. Each has unique responsibilities. When parents and teachers clearly respect and trust each other's roles while collaborating, a strong parent-teacher partnership forms that effectively supports the student.

Clarifying the Roles of Parents and Teachers

To collaborate respectfully, it is essential to understand each other's roles. Parents focus on the child's health, emotional well-being, and providing a suitable learning environment. Teachers, on the other hand, are responsible for academic instruction, school life guidance, and assessment. Despite these distinct responsibilities, cooperation between parents and teachers in areas such as career guidance, character development, and academic support leads to better outcomes.



By clearly understanding and practicing their roles, parents and teachers can fulfill their responsibilities. Parents provide emotional support and basic educational guidance, while teachers use their expertise to support academic achievement and character development. Trusting and collaborating with each other enables better support for the child.

Protecting Educational Activities

One way to show trust and respect toward teachers is to avoid infringing on their legitimate educational activities. Teachers' educational activities are protected under the Special Act on the Improvement of Teachers' Status and the Protection of Their Educational Activities. Understanding and supporting this protection enables schools to actively engage in students' education and allows teachers to focus more effectively on teaching.

Major educational activity infringement types are as follows:

Types of Educational Activity Infringement
1. Repeatedly interfering with a teacher's legitimate educational activities without justification 2. Repeatedly filing complaints without a legitimate purpose 3. Continuously demanding tasks outside the teacher's legal duties

Examples of Infringing Behavior		
Physical assault, threats, or verbal abuse toward teachers	Repeated unjust interference with legitimate educational activities	Illegal activities online (distribution of illegal information, defamation, unauthorized photography or sharing)
• Students disrupting class by insulting teachers, shouting, or using abusive language • Parents verbally abusing or threatening teachers while demanding changes to student records	• Parents repeatedly filing complaints, lawsuits, or reports to school offices or education authorities over dissatisfaction with teaching methods • Parents continually visiting the teachers' office to protest student guidance methods	• Students or parents posting false information about teachers on internet communities or social media • Students taking unauthorized photos of teachers during class and posting them online or leaving offensive comments

* Once entered, all contents in the student record cannot be arbitrarily deleted or modified by teachers.

Want to Know More?

Together school

Together School is a digital platform where students, teachers, and parents can share ideas and information. We'd love to hear what you think.



Together school

Utilizing External Resources

Supporting Your Child's Career Development



Do you feel that school-based activities alone are not enough for your child's career exploration and development? To help high school students explore careers beyond school, we introduce "Ggoomgil," a career experience support platform provided by the Ministry of Education.

Ggoomgil

꿈꾸는 아이들의 길잡이



"Guide for Dreaming Children" (Ggoomgil)

Ggoomgil is a nationwide public service platform designed to support various career experience programs. Institutions and companies that offer high-quality, free programs receive official Ministry of Education certification, which ensures that the programs and locations are properly managed. Through Ggoomgil, students can search for career experience programs based on grade level, school type, in-person or online format, location, region, and field of study or occupation.

* As of 2024, a total of 2,771 institutions nationwide

<Types of Career Experiences>

On-site vocational experiences	Practical job training	Field visits	Academic department experiences	Career camps	Lectures and interactive discussions
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<Regional Examples of Career Programs>

* Songpa-gu District, Seoul

- Offers structured curricula for future-oriented professions, such as AI prompt designers and space engineers, giving students opportunities to explore emerging careers
- Operated 12 free career experience sessions in the past two years, with diverse instructors providing a variety of hands-on programs

* Gwangju National Science Museum

- Offers school-grade-specific career education programs in emerging fields, including AI, biotechnology, and forensic science
- Equipped with specialized labs, 3D studios, classrooms, and dedicated instructors to provide high-quality STEM career experiences

2. Digesting Educational Policies

#Understanding the Curriculum

#Understanding Educational Changes

[Take a Step Forward Today]

I happened to glance at my child's timetable recently. I noticed that subjects and class formats have changed significantly since my school days. College admissions have also become more diverse and complex, making it essential to identify strategic admissions paths suited to my child. However, I have no idea where to start. Can you point me in the right direction?

2022 Revised National Curriculum

Key Points at a Glance



2022 Revised National Curriculum

1. Nurturing “Proactive Individuals with Inclusivity and Creativity”

In response to rapid social changes such as the Fourth Industrial Revolution, AI, pandemics, and declining birthrates, the 2022 Revised National Curriculum aims to cultivate individuals who combine inclusivity, respect for diversity and collaboration within communities, and creativity, essential skills for future society.

2. Competencies Developed Through the Curriculum

- 1) **Self-management competency:** Design one's life and career based on identity and confidence
- 2) **Knowledge and information processing competency:** Critically explore knowledge and solve problems rationally
- 3) **Creative thinking competency:** Integrate basic knowledge with new knowledge, skills, and experiences
- 4) **Aesthetic and emotional competency:** Gain insight into life's meaning through empathy for human and cultural experiences
- 5) **Collaborative communication competency:** Communicate effectively based on respect and cooperation
- 6) **Community competency:** Develop a responsible and open-minded attitude toward the nation and local community

3. Keywords to Know About the 2022 Revised National Curriculum

- **“With the People”:** Developed reflecting diverse public opinions
- **Decentralization & Autonomy:** Curriculum execution shifted from national to local and school levels for greater flexibility
- **Customized Curriculum:** Supports individualized learning tailored to each student's characteristics and career goals
- **Strengthened Digital/AI Literacy:** Expands AI, software, and information education to meet the demands of the digital era



Student-Centered Curriculum (High School Credit System)

- **What is the High School Credit System?** The High School Credit System allows students to select and complete courses tailored to their interests and aptitudes. Unlike the traditional uniform curriculum, students earn credits based on the courses they choose, creating a more personalized learning experience.
- **When does it start?** The system will be implemented for first-year high school students entering in 2025.
- **Key Features**
 - **Credit-Based Course Completion:** Credits are awarded when students attend at least two-thirds of class sessions and achieve 40% or higher in academic performance. Students must earn a minimum of 192 credits over three years to graduate.
 - **Personalized Learning:** Students can choose from various elective courses according to their career interests and aptitudes, enabling customized education.
 - **Support for Course Completion:** To ensure access to diverse subjects, schools provide cooperative curricula, online courses, and off-campus programs.
 - **Enhanced Career & Academic Planning Guidance:** Schools support students in systematically selecting courses aligned with their career paths and aptitudes.
 - **Accountable Education:** Minimum achievement guidance is provided for students at risk of not meeting course completion requirements.
 - **Credit System Learning Spaces:** Smart classrooms, online learning rooms, and home-base setups are created to facilitate the smooth operation of elective courses.
- **How to Take Courses Not Offered at Your School**
 - **Cooperative Curriculum:** Courses that cannot be offered due to low demand or teacher shortages are shared between schools.
 - **Online School:** Real-time interactive online classes are provided for courses not available through cooperative programs.
 - **Off-Campus Education:** Courses or creative experiential activities that cannot be offered at school or online may be completed at universities or local community institutions.

Scan the QR code to learn more about the High School Credit System.



High School Credit
System (EDUNET)

Admissions Officer System

• What is the Admissions Officer System?

The Admissions Officer System is a university admissions process in which students are evaluated comprehensively based on experiences and activities, in addition to academic grades. Many universities have adopted this system, though its specific implementation varies widely by institution.

• Key Evaluation Criteria

- **Academic Competence:** Evaluates overall academic ability beyond just grades and standardized test scores
- **Major Fit:** Assesses activities, career plans, and understanding related to the intended major
- **Potential for Growth:** Through the school record, evaluates self-directed learning, initiative, and problem-solving skills
- **Interview:** Evaluates character, achievements, and communication skills

• How to Prepare

- **Manage School Records:** Maintain grades while actively participating in classes, volunteering, and other school activities
- **Develop Self-Directed Learning:** Plan and execute your own learning, and expand knowledge through research activities related to your field
- **Explore Career Paths and Set Goals:** From first year of high school, explore interests and aptitudes, and plan activities related to your intended field
- **Prepare for Interviews:** Practice answering expected questions based on your chosen major and career goals, improving clear and logical communication skills

Scan the QR code to learn more about the Admissions Officer System.



University Admissions Officer System
National Archives of Korea, Ministry of the Interior and Safety



Admissions Types

Understanding University Admissions Types Thoroughly



Overview of University Admissions

Each university operates multiple types of admissions. According to the “Basic Information on University Admissions” published by the Korean Council for University Education, university admissions can be classified as student record-based (school record or comprehensive student record), essay-based, practical/achievement-based, or college entrance exam-based. However, since the specific evaluation components and their respective weights vary by university, it is important to carefully review each university’s official admissions guidelines for detailed information.

Admissions Types	Key Evaluation Components
Student Record-Based	• (School Transcript) Admissions based primarily on grades from the school transcript
	• (Comprehensive Student Record) Admissions involving a holistic evaluation, with participation from admissions officers, based on the student’s school record
Essay-Based	• Admissions evaluated through university-specific essay exams
Practical/Achievement-Based	• Admissions evaluated primarily on practical tests or achievements in relevant activities
Entrance Exam-Based	• Admissions primarily based on scores from the College Scholastic Ability Test (CSAT)

Admissions Schedule

Universities generally divide admissions into early admission and regular admission periods. Early admission usually occurs from September to early December, while regular admission takes place from late December to February. Note that specific dates for application submission and evaluation may vary by university, so always consult the official admission guidelines.



Want to Learn More?

If you want to find accurate admissions information and explore various admission strategies for the university your child wishes to attend, you can use Higher Education in Korea (www.academyinfo.go.kr) and the University Admissions Information Portal, Adiga (www.adiga.kr).

Higher Education in Korea



Higher Education in Korea

The Higher Education in Korea website, operated by the Korean Council for University Education, provides accurate information about universities. It organizes, in an easy-to-read format, each university's admissions guidelines for new and transfer students as well as the selection results for each type of admission over the past three years. In addition, it regularly publishes accurate information on each university's departments, tuition fees, and other relevant details on an annual basis.

University Public Disclosure Information		
Students	Educational Conditions	Budget, Settlement
• Selection methods used by the university • Academic evaluation • College enrollment and employment outcomes	• Support systems for students with disabilities • Dormitory capacity	• Tuition fees • Scholarship and financial aid status

University Admissions Information Portal, Adiga



University Admissions Information Portal, Adiga

The **University Admissions Information Portal, Adiga** (www.adiga.kr), operated by the Korean Council for University Education, provides comprehensive information on universities, departments, and admission types. It helps parents and students develop suitable admissions strategies based on academic records and career plans. The portal discloses each university's evaluation criteria and previous year's results, and offers a score-analysis service where students can compare their grades with past admissions results for the departments they wish to apply to.

* How to Check Previous Year's University Admissions Results

- Menu → Click Admissions Information Center "University-specific Admissions Information" → Click "Evaluation Criteria & Previous Year's Results by Admission Type" on the left → Click the desired university name → Check key details and results by admission type

* How to Perform Score Analysis

- Enter Scores: Sign up → My Page "Score Management" → Click "Select Score" → Click "Student Record" → Enter grades by year and semester on the left
- University-specific Score Analysis: Menu → Click Score Analysis "University-specific Score Analysis" → Enter the desired school and department → Check the desired admission type and click "Selection Analysis" → Compare last year's admission results (course grade bands) with your own grades

Changes to High School Grades Starting in 2025 (9-Grade System → 5-Grade System)

● What is the 5-Grade System?

From the 2025 school year, students entering high school will be evaluated using a 5-grade system instead of the previous 9-grade system. The grade distribution is as follows: Grade 1 (top 10%), Grade 2 (next 24%), Grade 3 (next 32%), Grade 4 (next 24%), and Grade 5 (bottom 10%). Both absolute evaluation (levels: A-E) and relative evaluation (grades: 1-5) will be recorded in the school transcript. However, certain subjects—science inquiry experiments, physical education & arts, social science integrated electives, and general education courses—will not include relative evaluation grades.

Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4	Grade 5
10%	24% (Cumulative 34%)	32% (Cumulative 66%)	24% (Cumulative 90%)	10% (Cumulative 100%)

<Grade Calculation and University Submission>

Category	Absolute Evaluation		Relative Evaluation	Statistical Information		
	Raw Score	Achievement Level	Grades	Distribution by Achievement	Subject Average	Number of Students
General Education Courses	○	A·B·C·D·E	5	○	○	○
Social Science Integrated Electives	○	A·B·C·D·E	-	○	○	○
Physical Education & Arts/Science Inquiry Experiments	-	A·B·C	-	-	-	-
General Elective Courses	-	P	-	-	-	-
Specialized Courses	○	A·B·C·D·E	5	○	○	○

● Reasons for the Change

- To reduce excessive competition caused by the 9-grade system amid declining student population!
- To maintain stability in college admissions while expanding student choice under the high school credit system!
- To emphasize creative and problem-solving skills through essay-type assessments!
- To promote integrated learning in social and science subjects and strengthen inquiry/problem-solving-focused instruction!

● How to Prepare

- **Focus on achievement-based learning:** Plan study to reach above certain score thresholds
- **Manage performance assessments:** Actively participate in projects, presentations, and other activities
- **Continue preparation for the CSAT:** Compensate for reduced differentiation in grades with regular study for the college entrance exam
- **Prepare for essay-type assessments:** Develop critical thinking and problem-solving skills
- **Pay attention in school:** Follow class trends to understand what may appear on school exams

Integrated & Converged CSAT Starting in 2028

Beginning with the 2028 academic year, the Korean College Scholastic Ability Test (CSAT) will transition to an integrated & converged format. All examinees will take the test in Korean, Mathematics, Social Studies, and Science without selecting individual elective subjects. Compared to the current CSAT, the 2028 integrated CSAT will have the following changes:

Subject	Current CSAT (through 2027)	Revision (2028 Integrated CSAT)
Korean	Common: Reading, Literature Choice (1): Speech & Writing, Language & Media	Common: Speech & Language, Reading & Writing, Literature
Math	Common: Math I, Math II Choice (1): Probability & Statistics, Calculus, Geometry	Common: Algebra, Calculus I, Probability & Statistics
English	Common: English I, English II	Common: English I, English II
Korean History	Common: Korean History	Common: Korean History
Social Studies, Science	Choice (up to 2 from 17 subjects) • Social Studies (9 subjects): Korean Geography, World Geography, World History, East Asian History, Economics, Politics & Law, Society & Culture, Life & Ethics, Ethics & Thought • Science (8 subjects): Physics I, Chemistry I, Biology I, Earth Science I, Physics II, Chemistry II, Biology II, Earth Science II	Common: Integrated Social Studies Common: Integrated Science
Vocational Education	1 subject (choose 1 from 5) 2 subjects: Common + 1 elective • Common: Successful Career Life • Choice (1): Basic Agricultural Technology, General Industry, Business Economics, Basic Fisheries & Shipping, Human Development	Common: Successful Career Life
Foreign Language/ Chinese Characters	Choice (1): German I, French I, Spanish I, Chinese I, Japanese I, Russian I, Arabic I, Vietnamese I, Chinese Characters I	Choice (1): German, French, Spanish, Chinese, Japanese, Russian, Arabic, Vietnamese, Chinese Characters



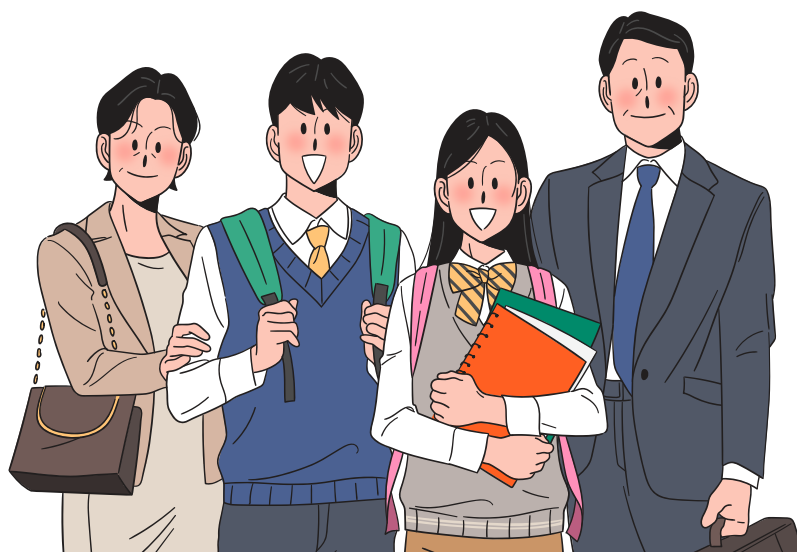
TIPS. College Admissions Preparation Strategy

1. [All Students Take the Same CSAT] With the removal of elective subjects, strategies that focus on improving scores in a few selected subjects are no longer effective. Students need to study all core subjects—Korean, Math, Social Studies, and Science—in a balanced way to maintain stable scores across the board.
2. [Social Studies and Science Will Be Tested as Integrated First-Year Subjects] Integrated Social Studies and Integrated Science are common for all students. Instead of studying selectively in depth, students should adopt a broad, comprehensive approach to understand and organize overall concepts.
3. [The 5-Grade System Does Not Make Grades Easier to Get] While it might seem that reducing from 9 grades to 5 lowers differentiation, competition among top students may intensify. Continuous, steady study remains essential.

[The Beginning of Change]

Since parent-teacher consultations are time-limited, it is helpful to reflect on your child's school life and learning status beforehand and think about the objectives and desired outcomes of the consultation. This preparation clarifies expectations and consultation goals.

Question	Answer
• What are your main concerns or challenges regarding your child lately?	Academic performance, study habits
• On a scale of 1 (not serious at all) to 5 (very serious), how severe do you consider this concern?	★★★★★
• Was there a specific incident or moment when you first recognized this concern?	After receiving midterm grades in the first semester of freshman year, results were lower than expected
• What do you hope to achieve or gain from the consultation? e.g., Problem-solving, advice, information, emotional support	Class behavior, guidance on career planning
• Preferred consultation format and time (in-person/phone/online)?	
• Any additional questions about your child's school life or other concerns?	





Leaving Footprints

In this chapter, we explored how parents can make the most of parent-teacher consultations and reviewed recent changes in high school education policies. In particular, understanding the High School Credit System newly implemented in the 2022 Revised National Curriculum, the increasingly diverse university admissions types, and the Admissions Officer System provides information that is definitely useful. Now, let's check your understanding by answering the questions below.

Q1. Which of the following is not a principle of parent-teacher consultations?

- ① Parents can request a consultation, and except in special cases, the content of the consultation remains confidential.
- ② Consultations should primarily take place outside of class hours, and the time must be coordinated in advance.
- ③ Teachers must always respond to consultation requests and cannot refuse a consultation even if the purpose and time are not agreed upon.
- ④ Teachers may refuse consultations that exceed their professional scope or occur outside working hours.

Q2. Which of the following statements about the High School Credit System is incorrect?

- ① The High School Credit System allows students to choose courses that fit their career paths and aptitudes, earning credits through a personalized education system.
- ② The High School Credit System provides the same courses across all high schools, eliminating differences in educational opportunities between schools.
- ③ The High School Credit System helps develop students' self-directed learning skills and assists with major selection for college admission.
- ④ The High School Credit System applies to all first-year high school students starting in 2025.

* Correct answers: 1-③, 2-②



Education paradigms change with global trends and shifts in industrial structures. Key education policies may seem complex, but they are manageable. Take an active interest in school participation and work closely with teachers to help shape your child's future.

Chapter 5

Giving Wings of Independence



1. Emerging Careers?

#Providing Opportunities for Self-Understanding, #Supporting Career Exploration,
#Cultivating Social Responsibility, #Cultural Sensitivity Education

2. Fostering Independence in Your Child

#Supporting Self-Esteem, #Providing Opportunities for Creative Problem-Solving,
#Supporting Resilience

Watching your child walk toward school in pursuit of their dreams, you may find yourself thinking,
"Their heart is still so childlike, yet their body has grown into an adult."
As your child stands on the threshold of making one of the most important decisions in life—
their career path—you may wonder how best to guide them.
Take a deep breath and open the first page.

[Me as a School Parent]

When It Gets Hard

Our child is still confused because they haven't found the career path that suits them yet. Seeing most of their friends already set on their paths and chasing their dreams seems to make them feel down and stressed.

As parents, we feel overwhelmed because we lack information and aren't in a financially comfortable position, and we don't know how to help.

It's Okay, These Things Happen!

At times like this, it's helpful for parents to try to understand their child's interests and strengths through conversation. Make sure to notice and praise even the small achievements your child makes—it will boost their confidence. The key is to support them so that they can make decisions on their own. If you want your child to develop the ability to explore their career path independently, these activities can help:



Job shadowing



Volunteer work



Extracurricular activities



Mentoring programs

Let's Check In with Ourselves

The following occupations are newly emerging careers introduced by the Ministry of Employment and Labor. How many of these occupations do you already know? For each occupation below, mark ○ if you know both the job title and its duties, △ if you have heard the job title before, and ★ if it is entirely new to you.

Mark (○/△/★)	Occupation	Duties
	Live Commerce Creator	Sells products through live video streaming on mobile platforms.
	Industrial Mathematics Moderator	Identifies various problems in the workplace, defines them mathematically, and evaluates the possibility of solving them using mathematical theories and analytical methods.
	Data Transaction Specialist	Handles data trading and brokerage, plans data productization, provides consulting, identifies demand markets (companies), and conducts data sales.
	Animal Health Technician	Assists veterinarians with urine and blood tests, dental procedures, tissue sample preparation, and various diagnostic and analytical tasks.

In a rapidly changing world, a wide variety of new and emerging occupations are appearing. For parents supporting their children's career exploration, it is important to understand these changes and be aware of the diverse types of occupations.

Let's Think

- Which occupations were you unaware of?
- Are the occupations you know still limited to those created in the past?
- Among the newly discovered occupations, which would you like to recommend to your child?

1. Emerging Careers?

#Providing Opportunities for Self-Understanding

#Supporting Career Exploration

#Cultivating Social Responsibility

#Cultural Sensitivity Education

[Take a Step Forward Today]

Starting this year, I've decided to have more concrete conversations with my child about their career. My child hasn't yet thought much about what they want to do, so they seem confused about which major to choose. I want to help with their career decisions, but I'm not sure what they might be good at. I also lack up-to-date information about recently changed college majors and don't know which careers are promising, so it's hard to make recommendations.

Understanding Your Child's Career Traits

Should You Try Various Career Assessments?



If parents deeply understand their child's career traits, they can support their career exploration more effectively. By using career aptitude tests, you can see which fields your child has strong abilities in. Career interest tests can show which areas your child finds engaging. These insights help your child choose a career path that maximizes their strengths while leading to long-term satisfaction.

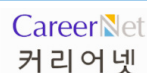
Conducting Career Assessments with Your Child



- Employment24 (Employment Support→Career Guide→Career Aptitude Tests)
- Operated by the Ministry of Employment and Labor and Korea Employment Information Service
- Provides assessments for career values, career aptitude, career interests, career readiness



Career Aptitude Tests
(Employment24)



- CareerNet (Career Psychological Test→Middle & High School Students)
- Operated by the Korea Research Institute for Vocational Education and Training
- Provides assessments for career values, career aptitude, career interests, career maturity



Development Capability Tests

Scan the QR codes above to conduct career assessments with your child, including career aptitude tests, career values tests, career maturity assessments, and career interest tests.

Exploring College Majors and Careers

Drawing a Career and Academic Roadmap for Your Child



Understanding College Major Categories

College majors are broadly divided into the following categories: Humanities & Social Sciences, Natural Sciences & Engineering, Education, Medicine, and Arts & Physical Education.

- **Humanities & Social Sciences**

Includes philosophy, history, literature, linguistics, and other humanities, as well as sociology, economics, political science, and other social sciences. These fields deal with topics such as people, culture, and social structures, helping students develop analytical and critical thinking skills.

- **Natural Sciences & Engineering**

Covers pure sciences such as mathematics, physics, chemistry, and biology, as well as engineering disciplines like mechanical engineering, electrical engineering, and computer engineering. Students learn scientific principles and technical problem-solving skills, gaining practical knowledge applicable across various industries.

- **Education**

Majors for training teachers, including elementary, secondary, early childhood, and special education, as well as education studies like pedagogy and lifelong education.

- **Medicine**

Includes medical, dental, veterinary, and nursing programs. These majors focus on human health and disease, emphasizing professional medical knowledge and patient care skills.

- **Arts & Physical Education**

Includes arts majors such as music, fine arts, theater, and dance, as well as physical education and sports science. These fields allow students to develop creativity and expression, enhancing artistic sensibilities or physical abilities.

Scan the QR code below for more information on college departments and majors!



University Admissions Information Portal, Adiga - Explore College Department information

Exploring Recently Popular College Majors

Let's look at examples of popular majors that could help your child in choosing a future career.

Major	Overview
Life Sciences/ Biotechnology	Studies the structure, function, growth, origin, and evolution of living organisms. In the 2025 admissions cycle, these majors showed the highest competition among natural sciences and engineering fields.
Software Engineering	Covers the design, development, and maintenance of computer software. Advanced IT-related majors such as AI, big data, and software are increasingly being introduced.
Business / Economics	Business majors study corporate management activities, while economics majors analyze economic phenomena and national economic systems. Business and economics programs tend to attract top-performing students in many universities.
Media-Related Majors	Train professionals in journalism, broadcasting, advertising, and public relations. Departments like Media Communication and Journalism & Video Studies show the highest competition among social science majors.

Q&A.

What Should I Do? Case Study: Interdisciplinary and Flexible Majors

Q. Parent's Concern

My child hasn't decided on a specific college major yet and wants to study more than one field at the same time. How can I help them maximize their interests and abilities?

A. Consider Flexible (Liberal) Majors and Interdisciplinary Majors!

Flexible (Liberal) majors allow students to decide their major after enrollment. Many universities offer these programs, and starting in 2025, major universities in Seoul will significantly expand admissions for flexible majors. Interdisciplinary majors combine two or more departments to create a distinct curriculum. For example, Seoul National University combines Industrial Engineering, Economics, and Business courses into the "Technology Management Interdisciplinary Major"; and Chung-Ang University offers a "Finance & AI Major" that integrates finance and artificial intelligence technology.

Exploring Emerging Careers

What careers are expected to be promising in the society of the future? According to media research on the “Most Promising Careers of 2025,” AI-related jobs rank among those expected to grow the fastest this year. Let’s take a look at other promising careers as well.

Rank	Occupation	Responsibilities	Related Majors
1	AI Engineer	• Design and implement AI models • Develop machine learning algorithms	Computer Science, AI-related majors
2	AI Consultant	• Advise companies on applying and utilizing AI technologies	Business Administration, AI-related majors
3	Physical Therapist	• Support health and rehabilitation in an aging society	Physical Therapy
4	Workforce Development Manager	• Support employee training and skill development	Business Administration, Industrial Engineering, etc.

Scan the QR code to explore more career information in the Korea Dictionary of Occupations on the Employment24 website.



Employment24 Korea
Dictionary of Occupations



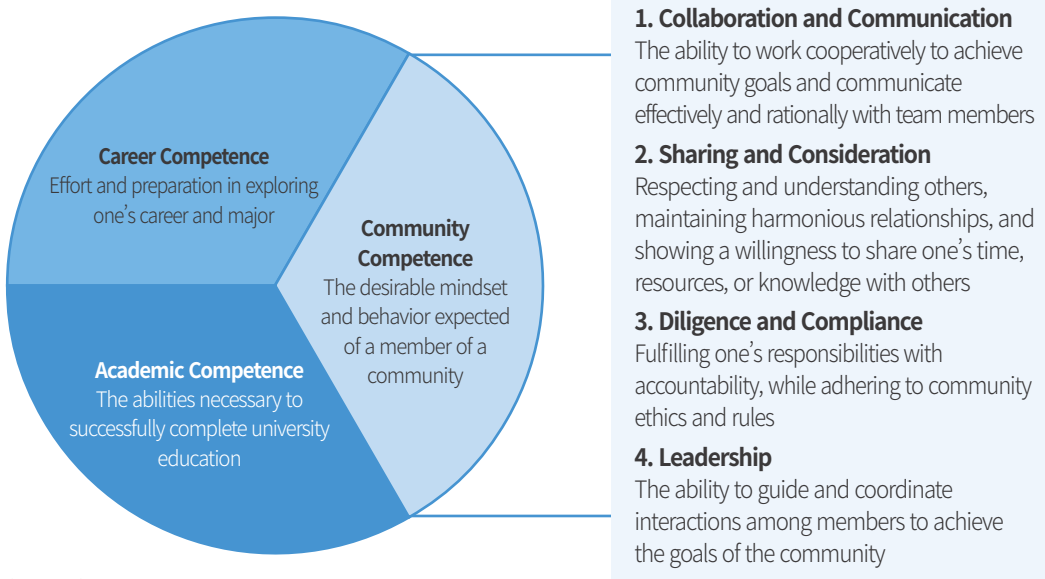
Choosing a career can be challenging. Your child may experience trial and error multiple times and sometimes return to the starting point, so it’s best to start career exploration as early as possible. Talking with your child to discover what they enjoy and what they are good at is very helpful. If this feels vague, using career assessments can provide an objective evaluation.

By reviewing career assessment results together and discussing recently promising careers or college majors, your child will naturally see that you are invested in their career development. This also helps them recognize the importance of making thoughtful career decisions on their own.



Understanding What Universities and Companies Seek

It is not enough for your child to achieve high academic performance and enter a desired university. It is equally important for them to grow into individuals with strong character and community skills who can contribute positively to society. Admissions research shows that many universities consider not only applicants' academic abilities and suitability for their chosen major but also their community skills. Similarly, top domestic companies prioritize responsibility, a spirit of challenge, communication, and collaboration over academic credentials when evaluating candidates for their workforce.



(Table 1) Trends in Desired Talent Rankings

Rank	2008	2013	2018	2023
1	Creativity	Spirit of Challenge	Communication & Collaboration	Responsibility
2	Expertise	Responsibility	Expertise	Spirit of Challenge
3	Spirit of Challenge	Expertise	Principles & Trust	Communication & Collaboration
4	Principles & Trust	Creativity	Spirit of Challenge	Creativity
5	Communication & Collaboration	Principles & Trust	Responsibility	Principles & Trust

While exceptional intelligence may be innate, strong character and community skills are developed gradually through school or family life and require ongoing effort. Below, we introduce ways families can help their children cultivate good character and community competencies at home.

- **Cultivate Responsibility**

It is important to give children small responsibilities in their daily lives. For example, assigning manageable household tasks such as cleaning their room or doing the dishes can help develop a sense of responsibility. Parents should demonstrate the tasks first, appropriate to the child's age and developmental level, and practice together for best results.

- **Adopt a Democratic Parenting Approach and Manage Achievement Pressure**

Appropriate pressure related to achievement can positively influence a child's emotional development. However, it is essential to understand your child's feelings and needs so that pressure does not feel like stress. Maintain a supportive attitude and focus praise on the process rather than just the results. It is also important to encourage children to act and take initiative on their own.

- **Support Social Participation Activities**

Helping your child participate in volunteer work or club activities can strengthen their sense of community. Encourage involvement in a variety of volunteer activities, and consider participating together. Motivating your child to join school or local clubs is also effective in fostering community awareness.

- **Set Specific Goals, Provide Success Experiences, and Allow Failure**

Encourage your child to set concrete goals and accumulate small successes. This approach builds their motivation and confidence. It is equally important to allow them to learn from failure and try again, which enhances problem-solving skills and self-efficacy.

- **Provide Autonomy and Self-Control Opportunities**

Give children the chance to make decisions and take responsibility by allowing them to plan their own learning and carry out their plans. This fosters opportunities to develop autonomy and self-regulation.



2. Fostering Independence in Your Child

#Supporting Self-Esteem

#Providing Opportunities for Creative Problem-Solving

#Supporting Resilience

[Take a Step Forward Today]

Lately, my child often makes decisions independently without asking for my opinion. I try to respect their choices, but I sometimes feel that their decisions are still immature. If this continues and they graduate from high school, they will immediately become adults. But is it okay that my child still can't even properly clean their own room?

Family Life Cycle and Developmental Tasks

Growth and Challenges for Our Family



Understanding the Family Life Cycle and Developmental Tasks

The changes in a family, such as members growing up, gaining independence, or retiring, are referred to as the family life cycle. Families encounter tasks and challenges at each stage of this cycle. According to Duvall's eight-stage theory, let's consider which stage our family is in with a high school-aged child and what challenges we can expect during this process.

Stage 1	Stage 2	Stage 3	Stage 4	Stage 5	Stage 6	Stage 7	Stage 8
Newlyweds	Childbearing family	Family with a young child	Family with a school-age child	Family with an adolescent	Family with a young adult	Middle-aged parents	Aging couple
	0-30 months	2-6 years	6-13 years	13-20 years			

Developmental Tasks of Families with Adolescents

- Provide sufficient opportunities for your child to explore their own values and identity.
- Shift communication from unilateral instructions to collaborative dialogue.
- Gradually flatten the family's hierarchical structure to encourage independent thinking.

Families with high school-aged children correspond to the “**Family with an Adolescent**” stage in the family life cycle. At this stage, parental roles gradually decrease, and it is important to balance freedom and responsibility to support your child's growing independence. Reflect on your own family if these tasks are being effectively addressed, or there are areas where more preparation is needed.

Essential Competencies for Independence

Helping Your Child Build Skills for Independence



Identifying Areas to Support Independence

As we saw in the family life cycle, parents of high school-aged children should begin preparing for the next stage: child independence. When children acquire the skills needed for independence, their responsibility and confidence increase, and they are better able to cope with stressful situations. Below are eight key areas necessary for independence. Review them and mark ★ for the areas in which your child is already doing well.

<Eight Areas of the Standardized Independence Support Program>

1. Daily Life Skills	Skills for daily living, including cooking, home management, and clothing care
↳ ☆☆☆☆☆	
2. Community Resource Utilization Skills	Skills to use local services, public institutions, recreational activities, and cultural facilities
↳ ☆☆☆☆☆	
3. Self-Management Skills	Skills for personal hygiene, health management, first aid, sex education, and fraud prevention
↳ ☆☆☆☆☆	
4. Social Skills	Skills for managing emotions, communication, interpersonal relationships, and contributing to society through volunteer work
↳ ☆☆☆☆☆	
5. Financial Management Skills	Developing proper economic concepts through education, managing allowances efficiently, and learning household management skills for post-independence life
↳ ☆☆☆☆☆	
6. Career Exploration Skills	Understanding occupations, completing career aptitude tests, exploring academic and career paths, planning for employment or entrepreneurship, and preparing resumes
↳ ☆☆☆☆☆	
7. Work Life Skills	Understanding employment and entrepreneurship, the roles and responsibilities of a professional, and acquiring job-related skills
↳ ☆☆☆☆☆	
8. Skills for Social Transition	Preparing for new beginnings, including finding housing, signing contracts, and moving
↳ ☆☆☆☆☆	

★★★★★ Excellent ★★★★★☆ Good ★★★★☆ Average

★★★☆☆ Needs Improvement ★☆☆☆☆ Needs Significant Improvement

Have you identified the areas in which your child is strong and the areas that need more development among these eight key areas? Now is the time to think about what steps you can take together to help your child build independence. Remember, your child's full independence is not immediate, so it's perfectly fine to prepare gradually.

Checking the Skills Needed for Independence

The Standardized Independence Support Program summarizes the skills your child should learn to live independently. Let's review the skills your child will need to acquire in the future.

<Standardized Independence Support Program>

Daily Life Skills	• Safely prepare meal kits or ready-to-eat packaged foods • Regularly clean and maintain the home
Community Resource Utilization Skills	• Understand how to obtain a driver's license and the costs associated with owning a car • Know whom to contact and what to do if witnessing a crime
Self-Management Skills	• Manage mental health (recognize and cope with stress) • Learn about various types of online crimes and ways to prevent becoming a victim • Understand dating, sexual health, STI prevention, pregnancy, and parenting issues, and know how to communicate with a partner about these topics
Social Skills	• Learn to handle conflicts arising from various relationships • Identify people who can provide help and understand how to seek assistance
Financial Management Skills	• Create a practical monthly spending plan • Understand concepts of taxes and year-end tax adjustments and associated responsibilities • Understand the characteristics (advantages, disadvantages, risks) of savings accounts, time deposits, and loans
Career Exploration Skills	• Gather information needed for career decisions • Develop and implement strategies for employment
Work Life Skills	• Understand the stages of job preparation, from job postings to interviews • Learn about rights and benefits after employment, and how to respond to workplace disputes
Skills for Social Transition	• Understand different housing options (e.g., lease types) and how to secure housing • Understand the rights and responsibilities of landlords and tenants

※ Source: National Center for the Rights of the Child. *Standardized Independence Support Program 2023*. Ministry of Health and Welfare, 2023.

While preparing your child for independence, parents should move beyond simply providing answers or giving instructions. It is important to recognize your child as an independent individual who can cooperate with you. At this stage, identifying the skills your child needs for independence and helping them develop these skills together is essential.



[The Beginning of Change]

Reflecting on Your Own Independence Journey

Take some time to reflect on your own path to independence and answer the following questions. When parents review their own experiences, it can be incredibly helpful in supporting their child's growing independence.

1. Did you receive any support or help when you first became independent from home? If so, what kind of support was it?

2. What challenges did you face after becoming fully independent? What frustrations or setbacks did you experience, and how did you handle them?

3. How might your situation differ from your child's situation? Based on your experience, what advice would you like to give your child?

By sharing both challenges and successful experiences with your child, you help them set more realistic expectations and prepare effectively for independence. Reflecting on the lessons you learned during your own journey allows you to provide practical and valuable guidance. For example, if your own independence began suddenly without a plan, you can help your child create a more gradual, well-thought-out plan for becoming independent.



Leaving Footprints

This chapter explored ways to support your child's career choices and foster independence. Based on what you've learned, consider what your family can do to help your child grow healthily. Use the questions below to check your understanding.

Q1. I have gained new ideas about my child's career path based on recent information about promising university majors and jobs.



Q2. I have learned about new university majors and emerging career opportunities.



Q3. I know what is needed for my child's independence and am prepared to support both my child and myself.



The transition from a high school-aged child under the care of school and parents to a responsible adult fulfilling their own duties is one of the most critical stages in life. During this period, emotional support and encouragement are far more effective than instructions that may be perceived as nagging. Observe your child with unwavering faith, offering support so they can face challenges confidently and grow through their experiences.



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